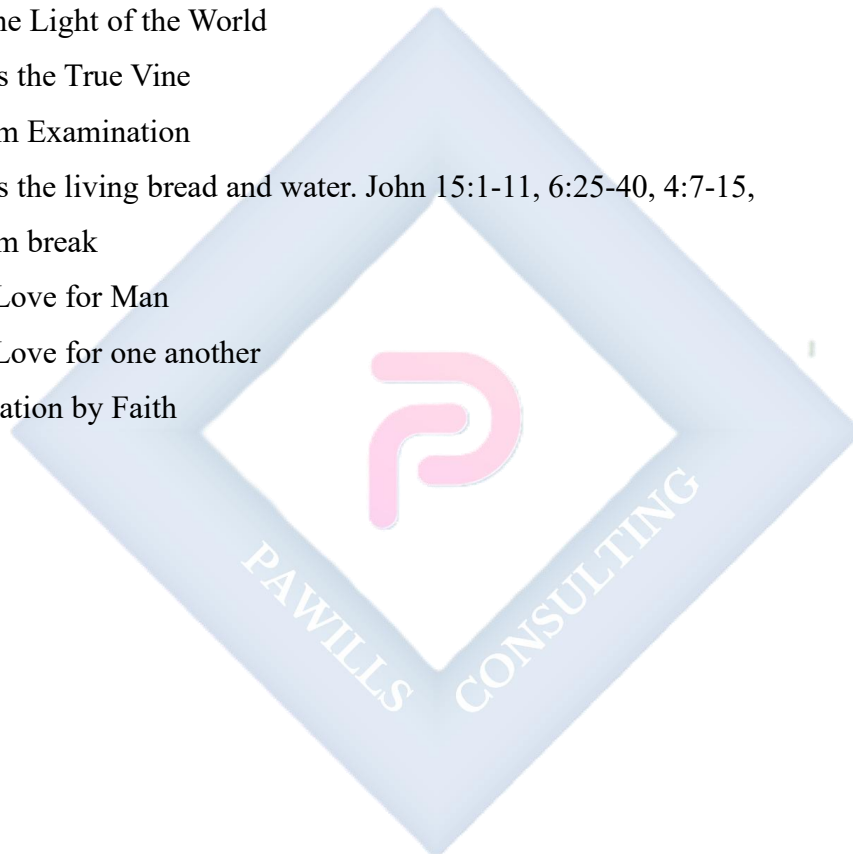


SS 1 – CHRISTIAN RELIGIOUS STUDIES LESSON

NOTES

FIRST TERM

1. Jesus as the Lamb, the Door, and the Good Shepherd I
2. Jesus as the Lamb, the Door, and the Good Shepherd II
3. Jesus the Light of the World
4. Jesus as the True Vine
5. Midterm Examination
6. Jesus as the living bread and water. John 15:1-11, 6:25-40, 4:7-15,
7. Midterm break
8. God's Love for Man
9. God's Love for one another
10. Justification by Faith



WEEK 1 & 2: JESUS AS THE LAMB, THE DOOR, AND THE GOOD SHEPHERD

Theme: The Metaphorical "I AM" of Jesus

Biblical Texts: John 1:29–34, 10:1–18; Isaiah 53:7; Psalm 23.

Duration: 2 Weeks

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this unit, students should be able to:

1. Explain the prophetic and historical significance of Jesus being called the "Lamb of God."
 2. Analyze the metaphor of the "Door" regarding salvation and spiritual security.
 3. Differentiate between the "Good Shepherd" and the "Hired Hand" based on their motivations and actions.
 4. Apply the qualities of the Good Shepherd (leadership, sacrifice, care) to their own lives and future leadership roles.
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II. PART 1: JESUS AS THE LAMB OF GOD

Biblical Focus: John 1:29–34; Isaiah 53:7

1. The Biblical Declaration

The lesson begins at the river Jordan, where John the Baptist identifies Jesus. He declares, *"Behold, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!"*. This was a radical identity statement that linked Jesus to centuries of Jewish history and prophecy.

2. Cultural & Historical Context (The "Why")

To understand the "Lamb," students must understand the Jewish sacrificial system:

- **The Passover Lamb:** In Jewish tradition, a lamb was sacrificed during the Passover to commemorate God sparing the Israelites in Egypt. The blood of the lamb was the sign of safety. Jesus is presented as the *ultimate* Passover sacrifice.

The Suffering Servant (Isaiah 53:7): The Old Testament prophet Isaiah described the coming Messiah as a lamb led to the slaughter. This predicted that the Savior would be silent, humble, and willing to suffer.

- **Innocence and Purity:** A sacrificial lamb had to be "without blemish." Jesus is the spiritual fulfillment of this requirement—He was sinless, innocent, and pure.

3. Theological Significance: Substitutionary Atonement

Taking Away Sin: Unlike the Old Testament sacrifices which *covered* sin temporarily, Jesus' role was to *take away* sin permanently.

Universal Redemption: John says, "sin of the *world*," indicating that Jesus' mission extends beyond the Jewish nation to all humanity.

4. Life Application

- **Humility:** Just as the Lamb represents humility and submission to God's will, students are called to live without arrogance.

Sacrifice: True love often requires sacrificing our own comfort for the good of others.

III. PART 2: JESUS AS THE DOOR

Biblical Focus: John 10:1–10

1. The Metaphor of the Sheepfold

In ancient Palestine, sheepfolds were often simple stone enclosures with a single opening and no physical gate. At night, the shepherd would sleep across the opening.

- **The Shepherd is the Door:** Literally, nothing could enter or leave without passing over the shepherd's body.

Relevance: When Jesus says, "I am the door," He is describing Himself as the literal physical barrier between the sheep (believers) and danger.

2. Key Functions of the Door

Access (Exclusivity): Jesus states, "*If anyone enters by me, he will be saved*". This teaches that there are not multiple ways to salvation; the access point is specific and exclusive.

Protection (Security): The door shuts out thieves (false teachers) and wolves (spiritual danger).

- **Abundant Life:** Going "in and out" to find pasture symbolizes freedom and nourishment. Jesus contrasts Himself with the "thief" who comes only to steal, kill, and destroy. Jesus came to give life in abundance.

3. Discussion Point

- **Topic:** "In a pluralistic world, why does Christianity teach that Jesus is the *only* door?" (Discuss John 14:6 in relation to John 10:7) .

IV. PART 3: JESUS AS THE GOOD SHEPHERD

Biblical Focus: John 10:11–18; Psalm 23

1. The Good Shepherd vs. The Hired Hand

This distinction is crucial for understanding leadership.

- **The Good Shepherd (Owner):**
- **Motivation:** Love and ownership. The sheep belong to Him.

Action in Danger: Lays down his life to save the sheep.

Relationship: He knows them by name, and they recognize His voice.

- **The Hired Hand (Contractor):**
- **Motivation:** Money/Wages. He has no personal stake in the flock.

Action in Danger: Abandons the sheep and flees when the wolf comes.

2. Characteristics of Jesus as Shepherd

- **Sacrificial Leadership:** "I lay down my life for the sheep." This prophesied His crucifixion.
- **Intimacy:** "I know my own and my own know me." This parallels the relationship between God the Father and the Son.
- **Universal Mission (Ecumenism):** Jesus mentions having "other sheep not of this fold" (Gentiles). His goal is unity: "one flock, one shepherd".

3. Psalm 23 Connection

The attributes of the Good Shepherd in John 10 reflect the promises of Psalm 23:

He leads me (Guidance).

I will fear no evil (Protection).

He restores my soul (Care/Nourishment).

V. SUMMARY: REFLECTION OF NATURE AND MISSION

Metaphor	Jesus' Nature (Character)	Jesus' Mission (Action)
The Lamb	Innocent, pure, sinless	Substitutionary sacrifice for sin
The Door	Mediator, guardian, protector	Providing access to God and eternal life
The Shepherd	Compassionate, faithful, relational	Leading, nourishing, and dying for the flock

EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions (Essay/Discussion):

1. **Contextual Analysis:** Explain how the ancient Jewish practice of shepherding helps us understand Jesus' claim to be the "Door." Why is a physical gate not necessary in this context?
2. **Comparative Analysis:** Compare the attitude of a "Hired Hand" leader versus a "Good Shepherd" leader in a modern context (e.g., a school prefect, a politician, or a class captain).

3. **Theological Application:** "Jesus is the Lamb." How does this statement in John 1 contradict the popular Jewish expectation of a conquering military Messiah?

B. Objective Revision:

1. Identify the prophet who described the Messiah as a lamb led to the slaughter. (*Answer: Isaiah*)
2. Jesus mentions "other sheep" in John 10:16. Who does this refer to? (*Answer: The Gentiles/Non-Jews*)
3. Complete the statement: "The thief comes only to steal and kill and destroy; I have come that they may have ____." (*Answer: Life, and have it abundantly*)

C. Assignment:

- **Project:** Write a "Shepherd's Code of Conduct" for your class. List 5 rules that a class leader should follow, based on the qualities of the Good Shepherd (protection, sacrifice, knowing the sheep).

VII. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Visual Aid:** Use an image of a traditional Middle Eastern sheepfold (stone walls, one gap) to visualize the "Door" metaphor.
 - **Pedagogical Tip:** When teaching the "Lamb," connect it to the concept of "innocence." Ask students if they have ever been punished for something someone else did. This helps them understand the weight of *vicarious* sacrifice.
 - **Structure:** Ensure Week 1 covers "The Lamb" and "The Door," while Week 2 focuses entirely on "The Good Shepherd" to allow enough time for the Psalm 23 cross-reference.
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WEEK 3: JESUS THE LIGHT OF THE WORLD

Theme: Divine Revelation and Moral Guidance

Biblical Texts: John 8:12; John 1:1–9; John 9:1–5; Matthew 5:14–16; Psalm 119:105.

Duration: 1 Week

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. **Contextualize** Jesus' declaration "I am the Light" within the Jewish Festival of Tabernacles.
 2. **Analyze** the metaphorical contrast between spiritual light and spiritual darkness using biblical examples.
 3. **Differentiate** between Jesus as the *Source* of light (John 8) and Christians as the *Reflection* of light (Matthew 5).
 4. **Develop** a personal action plan for "walking in the light" within the school environment.
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II. PART 1: THE METAPHOR OF LIGHT

Biblical Focus: John 8:12; John 1:4–5

1. Definition and Nature of Light

Physical Definition: Light is a form of energy that stimulates sight and makes things visible. It allows us to distinguish objects, colors, and shapes.

- **The Theological Contrast:** In the Bible, light and darkness are not just physical states but spiritual realities.

Light Represents: Truth , Purity and Holiness , Knowledge/Wisdom , God's Presence , Righteousness , and Salvation. It stands for everything good and godly.

Darkness Represents: Sin, ignorance, evil, and separation from God.

2. Historical Context: The Feast of Tabernacles (The "Why")

To truly understand John 8:12, students must understand *where* Jesus was.

- Jesus made this statement during the **Feast of Tabernacles** in the Temple courts.
- During this festival, massive golden candelabras (lamps) were lit in the Court of Women to remind the Israelites of the **Pillar of Fire** that guided them through the wilderness.
- When Jesus said, *"I am the light of the world,"* He was effectively saying: *"I am the reality that the pillar of fire pointed to. I am the true presence of God guiding you through the wilderness of life."*

III. PART 2: THE FUNCTIONS OF JESUS AS LIGHT

Biblical Focus: John 8:12; John 9:5

When Jesus calls Himself the Light, it implies three active functions:

1. Revelation (He Reveals Truth)

- Just as physical light allows people to see reality, Jesus reveals the truth about God.
- Without Christ, humanity is in "spiritual ignorance", unable to see the true nature of God or the purpose of life.

2. Exposure (He Exposes Sin)

- Light makes hidden things visible. When light shines into a dark room, dust and dirt become visible.
- Similarly, Jesus' perfect life and teachings expose sin and evil in the world. His presence challenges people to repent because their "works of darkness" can no longer be hidden.

3. Guidance (He Directs Paths)

- Psalm 119:105 describes God's word as a "lamp to my feet."
- Jesus guides believers to righteousness. Like a lamp on a dark path, He helps believers avoid "spiritual obstacles" (pitfalls of sin, bad decisions, false teachings).

IV. PART 3: THE BELIEVER AS A REFLECTION OF LIGHT

Biblical Focus: Matthew 5:14–16; Ephesians 5:8

1. Source vs. Reflection

- **Jesus (The Sun):** He is the *source* of light. He generates truth and life.
- **The Christian (The Moon):** We have no light of our own. We shine only by *reflecting* His light.
- **The Mandate:** Jesus said, "You are the light of the world." This means Christians must live in a way that draws attention not to themselves, but to God.

2. Practical Ways to Reflect Light

The lesson note identifies specific behaviors that dim or brighten a Christian's light:

Moral Integrity: Avoiding sinful behaviors like lying, stealing, and immorality. In a school setting, this includes avoiding examination malpractice.

Universal Love: Demonstrating genuine love regardless of race, religion, or background.

Bold Witness: Sharing the gospel respectfully.

Positive Influence: Being a peacemaker and a voice for justice in the community.

V. SUMMARY: THE TRIUMPH OF LIGHT

- **Victory:** Light is stronger than darkness. John 1:5 declares, *"The light shines in the darkness, and the darkness has not overcome it."*

Hope: Jesus came to destroy the works of the devil. No matter how "dark" the world or a situation seems, the Light of Christ brings clarity, direction, and hope.

EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Discussion/Essay Questions:

1. **Metaphorical Analysis:** "Darkness cannot drive out darkness; only light can do that."
Discuss how this quote relates to Jesus' role as the Light of the World in overcoming sin.
2. **Personal Application:** Identify a "dark" area in your school environment (e.g., bullying, cheating, peer pressure). How can you, as a student, shine light in that specific area?
3. **Theological Distinction:** Explain the difference between Jesus saying "I am the Light" (John 8) and telling the disciples "You are the Light" (Matthew 5).

B. Objective Review:

1. What natural phenomenon does the Bible use to symbolize sin and ignorance? (*Answer: Darkness*)
2. Complete the verse: "The light shines in the darkness, and the darkness has not _____ it." (*Answer: Overcome/Comprehend*)
3. According to the lesson, light allows us to distinguish three things. Name two. (*Answer: Objects, colors, shapes*)

C. Assignment:

Reflective Writing (150 Words): Write an essay titled "How I Can Be a Light in My School and Community". Focus on three specific actions you will take this week (e.g., helping a struggling student, telling the truth when it is difficult, forgiving someone).

VII. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Scientific Analogy:** Bring a flashlight to class. Turn off the lights. Show how a small light naturally draws attention and dispels darkness. Use this to explain how a Christian's behavior should stand out in the world.
- **Differentiation:** For advanced students, ask them to read John 9 (The healing of the blind man) and explain how Jesus gave *physical* light to the blind man to prove He gives *spiritual* light to the world.

- **Key Takeaway:** Ensure students leave understanding that "Walking in the Light" is not just about avoiding sin, but about actively revealing God's truth and love to others.



WEEK 4: JESUS AS THE TRUE VINE

Theme: Vitality, Dependence, and Fruitfulness

Biblical Texts: John 15:1–17; Galatians 5:22–23; Isaiah 5:1–7.

Duration: 1 Week

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. **Interpret** the symbolism of the Vine, the Vinedresser, and the Branches within the context of 1st-century Palestinian agriculture.
 2. **Distinguish** between the "Old Vine" (Israel) and the "True Vine" (Jesus).
 3. **Analyze** the difference between "pruning" (discipline/growth) and "cutting off" (judgment).
 4. **Evaluate** the necessity of "abiding" for spiritual survival and identify practical ways to remain connected to Christ.
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II. PART 1: THE METAPHOR EXPLAINED

Biblical Focus: John 15:1, 5

1. Cultural and Botanical Context

The Vine in Palestine: The grapevine was a central part of Jewish life and economy. It is a plant with a long stem that climbs or creeps along the ground.

- **The "True" Vine:**
- *Historical Background:* In the Old Testament (Isaiah 5, Psalm 80), Israel was often called God's vine. However, Israel often failed to produce good fruit (disobedience).

Jesus' Claim: By calling Himself the **True Vine**, Jesus declares that He is the perfect, faithful Israel who fulfills what the nation could not. He is the authentic source of life.

2. The Cast of Characters

- **The True Vine (Jesus):** He is the trunk and the source of life. Just as sap flows from the vine to the branches, spiritual life flows from Jesus to believers. Without this connection, spiritual life is impossible.
- **The Vinedresser (God the Father):** He is the gardener. His role is to tend, protect, and manage the growth of the vine. He is actively involved in the life of the believer to ensure productivity.
- **The Branches (Believers):** Christians are the branches. Their sole purpose is to receive nourishment from the vine and produce fruit.

III. PART 2: THE PROCESS – ABIDING AND PRUNING

Biblical Focus: John 15:2–8

1. The Two Actions of the Father

Jesus describes two distinct actions God takes, depending on the branch's condition:

Cutting Off (Judgment): Branches that bear *no* fruit are removed. This represents spiritual barrenness and separation from God. These dead branches are gathered and burned, symbolizing judgment.

Pruning (Discipline & Growth): Branches that *do* bear fruit are pruned "so that it may bear more fruit".

- *What is Pruning?* In gardening, this involves cutting away unwanted shoots or leaves that drain energy.
- *Spiritual Pruning:* This refers to God removing hindrances in a believer's life (bad habits, distractions, pride) to improve character. It may be painful, but it is necessary for greater fruitfulness.

2. The Condition: Abiding (Remaining)

Definition: To "abide" means to stay connected, dwell, or remain in constant fellowship.

- **How to Abide:**

Word & Obedience: Living according to His teachings.

Prayer: Maintaining constant communication.

Faith: Accepting Him as Lord and Saviour.

Dependence: Relying on the Holy Spirit for power, not self-effort.

IV. PART 3: THE RESULT – FRUITFULNESS AND LOVE

Biblical Focus: John 15:9–17

1. The Meaning of "Fruit"

When Jesus speaks of fruit, He implies three dimensions:

Character: The "Fruit of the Spirit" (Galatians 5:22–23) — love, joy, peace, etc..

- **Good Works:** Acts of kindness and righteousness.
- **Evangelism:** Winning souls for the Kingdom.

2. The Benefits of Abiding

Answered Prayers: Jesus promises, "Ask whatever you wish, and it shall be done for you".

Fullness of Joy: A deep, lasting joy that comes from God's presence, not external circumstances.

Glorifying God: A productive Christian life brings honor to the Father.

3. The Supreme Command: Love

- Jesus transitions from the vertical (God-man) relationship to the horizontal (man-man) relationship.

- **The Link:** You cannot abide in the Vine without loving the other branches. Jesus commands us to "love one another".
- **The Standard:** We must love "as I have loved you"—sacrificially. He gave His life for His friends, which is the highest form of love.

V. SUMMARY: CONNECTION VS. ISOLATION

Aspect	Abiding (Connected)	Not Abiding (Disconnected)
Status	Living Branch	Dead/Withered Branch
Action by God	Pruned (Cleaned)	Cut Off
Result	Fruitfulness (More Fruit)	Barrenness (Fire/Judgment)
Experience	Joy, Answered Prayer	Spiritual Emptiness, Loss of Peace

VI. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions:

1. **Analogy Analysis:** Why can a branch *never* produce fruit by itself? Apply this to a Christian trying to be "good" without praying or reading the Bible.
2. **Theological Reflection:** Explain the difference between "pruning" and "punishment." How might a student interpret a difficult situation (e.g., failing a test after not studying) as "pruning"?
3. **Synthesis:** Jesus calls us "friends" in John 15. How does this change our understanding of obedience compared to being just "servants"?

B. Objective Review:

1. In the metaphor of the True Vine, who represents the Vinedresser? (*Answer: God the Father*).
2. State the consequence for a branch that does not abide in the vine. (*Answer: It is thrown into the fire/burned/withers*).

3. According to John 15:7, what is a key benefit of abiding in Christ regarding prayer? (*Answer: You may ask what you wish, and it shall be done*).

C. Assignment:

- **Personal Application:** Identify one "sucker shoot" (distraction or bad habit) in your life that might need "pruning" to help you study better or be a better Christian. Write a paragraph explaining how you will allow God to prune this.
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VII. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Visual Aid:** Bring a small branch or plant to class. Cut a piece off and set it aside at the beginning of the lesson. By the end of the lesson, show how the cut piece has already started to wilt compared to the plant. This visually demonstrates the immediate death caused by disconnection.
- **Key Distinction:** Ensure students understand that *pruning* is positive (painful but helpful), while *cutting off* is negative. This prevents them from viewing every hardship as God rejecting them.
- **Interactive Element:** Ask students to list "Nutrients" the branch needs (e.g., Prayer, Word, Fellowship) and "Pests" that attack the branch (e.g., Sin, Laziness, Bad Company). Here is the comprehensive, improved lesson note for **Week 6**.

WEEK 6: JESUS AS THE LIVING BREAD AND WATER

Theme: Spiritual Satisfaction and Sustenance

Biblical Texts: John 6:25–40; John 4:7–15.

Duration: 1 Week

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. **Contrast** physical hunger/thirst with spiritual hunger/thirst.
 2. **Analyze** the conversation between Jesus and the Jews regarding "Manna" versus the "True Bread."
 3. **Explain** the cultural barriers broken by Jesus in His conversation with the Samaritan woman (Living Water).
 4. **Evaluate** the significance of Jesus as the only source of eternal satisfaction.
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II. PART 1: JESUS AS THE LIVING BREAD

Biblical Focus: John 6:25–40

1. The Context: Misplaced Priorities

After Jesus miraculously fed the multitude (Feeding of the 5,000), the crowd followed Him to the other side of the sea (Capernaum).

The Crowd's Motive: Jesus rebuked them, revealing they were seeking Him not because of the spiritual signs (miracles proving His divinity), but simply because they had eaten their fill of bread. They wanted a political provider, not a spiritual Savior.

The Command: Jesus urged them: *"Do not labor for the food which perishes, but for the food which endures to everlasting life"*. He identified the "Son of Man" as the only one with the authority to give this food.

2. The "Work" of God

The people asked what they must do to perform the works of God.

Jesus' Answer: The work of God is not a list of tasks, but a singular act of faith: **"Believe in Him whom He sent"**. This shifted the focus from *earning* salvation to *receiving* a person.

3. The Comparison: Manna vs. The True Bread

The crowd challenged Jesus, demanding a sign like Moses, who gave their forefathers manna in the wilderness. Jesus corrected their theology on two points:

Source: It was not Moses who gave the bread, but God the Father.

- **Nature:** Manna was temporary physical relief. The "bread of God" is He who comes down from heaven and gives life to the world.

Comparison Table: Manna vs. Jesus

Feature	Manna (Old Testament)	Jesus (New Testament)
Origin	Physical food from the sky	Spiritual bread from Heaven
Purpose	Temporary relief from hunger	

| Eternal spiritual life

|| **Result** | They ate and eventually died | Whoever eats lives forever |

III. PART 2: JESUS AS THE LIVING WATER

Biblical Focus: John 4:7–15

1. The Setting: Jacob's Well

Jesus was resting at Jacob's Well in Samaria while His disciples went to buy food. A Samaritan woman came to draw water, and Jesus asked her for a drink.

Breaking Barriers: The woman was shocked because **Jews and Samaritans had no dealings** with one another. Jesus broke social (gender) and racial (Samaritan) protocols to reach her.

2. The Dialogue: Well Water vs. Living Water

The Offer: Jesus told her that if she knew the "gift of God" and who was speaking, *she* would have asked *Him* for **Living Water**.

The Woman's Confusion: She took Him literally, noting that He had no vessel (bucket) and the well was deep. She asked if He was greater than their ancestor Jacob, who provided the well.

3. The Promise: Eternal Springs

Jesus made a definitive distinction between the physical water in the well and the spiritual water He offers:

Physical Water: *"Everyone who drinks of this water will thirst again"*. It provides only temporary satisfaction.

Living Water: *"The water that I shall give him will become in him a spring of water welling up to eternal life"*.

Result: The recipient will **never thirst**. This represents the Holy Spirit and the total satisfaction found in God.

The Response: The woman, desiring to end her physical labor, requested this water: *"Sir, give me this water, that I may not thirst, nor come here to draw"*.

IV. PART 3: THEOLOGICAL SIGNIFICANCE

Biblical Focus: John 6 & 4

1. Metaphorical Meaning

When Jesus calls Himself "Bread" and "Water," He is speaking metaphorically. He is using the most basic human necessities to explain spiritual needs. Just as the body dies without food and water, the human spirit is dead without Christ.

2. The Universal Invitation

Salvation for All: The "Living Water" represents the Word of God and Salvation. This offer was made to a Samaritan (a non-Jew), signifying that salvation is **universal**—for all nations of the world.

Sustainability: Jesus stated that this water "wells up" to eternal life, meaning the Word of God stands the test of time and sustains anyone who embraces it.

V. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Discussion Questions (Essay/Critical Thinking):

1. **Contrast:** "Manna sustained life for a day; Jesus sustains life for eternity." Discuss this statement in light of John 6. Why do you think people still prefer "manna" (material things) over "true bread" (spiritual things) today?
2. **Cultural Analysis:** Why was the Samaritan woman surprised that Jesus spoke to her? How does this teach us about who the Gospel is for?
3. **Personal Reflection:** Identify "broken cisterns" in modern life—things people "drink" from to find happiness that leave them thirsty again (e.g., social media fame, money, addiction).

B. Objective Revision:

1. In John 6, what "work" did Jesus say God requires of us? (*Answer: To believe in Him whom God sent*).
2. What was the specific physical difference between the water in Jacob's well and the water Jesus offered? (*Answer: One causes thirst again; the other leads to never thirsting/eternal life*).

3. Who gave the Israelites manna in the wilderness? (*Answer: God the Father, not Moses*).

C. Assignment:

- **Scripture Search:** Read John 6:35. Write a short paragraph explaining the phrase: "*I am the bread of life. He who comes to Me shall never hunger.*" How does this relate to "spiritual hunger"?
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VI. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Visual Aid:** Bring a cup of water and a piece of bread to class. Ask students how long they can go without them. Use this to illustrate the *desperation* the human soul should feel for God.
- **Key Concept:** Emphasize that "Living Water" in ancient times referred to *flowing* water (like a river or spring), which was fresh and clean, as opposed to *stagnant* well water. Jesus used this physical reality to describe the active, moving power of the Holy Spirit.
- **Class Activity:** Have students role-play the conversation at the well to highlight the initial confusion of the woman and the patience of Jesus.

WEEK 8: GOD'S LOVE FOR MAN

Theme: The Nature of Divine Affection and Sacrifice

Biblical Texts: John 3:16–18; Romans 5:8; 1 John 4:7–10; Genesis 1:26–28.

Duration: 1 Week

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. **Define** "God's Love" (Agape) and distinguish it from human forms of love.
 2. **Trace** the evidence of God's love from the act of Creation (Genesis) to the act of Redemption (John).
 3. **Analyze** John 3:16 to identify the nature, beneficiary, and goal of God's love.
 4. **Formulate** a personal response to God's love through obedience and love for others.
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II. PART 1: THE MEANING AND NATURE OF GOD'S LOVE

Biblical Focus: Romans 5:8; 1 John 4:8

1. Definition: Agape

Unconditional: God's love refers to His deep, unconditional, and sacrificial affection for humanity. Unlike human love, which is often based on attraction or merit ("I love you because..."), God's love is based on His character. He loves because *He is love* (1 John 4:8).

Everlasting: It is not fleeting or emotional; it is constant and forgiving.

- **Initiative:** God loved us *first*, even while we were sinners (Romans 5:8).

2. Evidence in Creation (Genesis 1:26–28)

God's love did not start at the cross; it started at the beginning of time.

The Imago Dei (Image of God): Man was the *only* creature created in God's own image. This bestows inherent dignity, value, and purpose upon every human being.

Dominion: God entrusted humanity with authority over all other creatures. This delegation of power is a sign of trust and love.

Significance: This gives man purpose and dignity. We are not accidents of biology; we are loved designs of a Creator.

III. PART 2: THE ULTIMATE PROOF – REDEMPTION

Biblical Focus: John 3:16–18

1. The Problem: Separation

Despite God's love in creation, humanity fell into sin. Sin brought condemnation and separation from God.

2. The Solution: The Gift of the Son

God, in His deep love, sent His only Son, Jesus Christ, to die and shed His blood. This is the climax of divine love.

- **Analysis of John 3:16:**
- *"For God so loved the world":* The **Scope** is universal. It includes every race, nation, and sinner.
- *"That He gave His only begotten Son":* The **Sacrifice** is infinite. It was the highest price God could pay.
- *"That whoever believes in Him should not perish":* The **Condition** is faith. It is accessible to anyone.

"But have eternal life": The **Goal** is restoration and life, not condemnation.

3. No Condemnation

Jesus clarified that He did not come to condemn the world, but to save it. Condemnation is for those who refuse the light; salvation is for those who embrace the Son.

IV. PART 3: MAN'S RESPONSE TO GOD'S LOVE

Biblical Focus: Mark 12:30; 1 John 4:11; John 14:15

How should a human being respond to such overwhelming love?

1. Reciprocal Love (Vertical)

Worship & Praise: Man shows appreciation by maintaining an intimate relationship with God through worship.

Faith: Having strong faith in Him is a response to His faithfulness.

- **Obedience:** Jesus said, "*If you love Me, keep My commandments*" (John 14:15). Obedience is the "love language" of the believer.

2. Love for Others (Horizontal)

- **The Logic of Love:** "Beloved, if God so loved us, we also ought to love one another" (1 John 4:11). We cannot claim to love God while hating His creation.
- **Practical Application:**

Family & Strangers: Showing kindness to everyone, not just friends.

Forgiveness: Being forgiving and generous, mirroring God's treatment of us.

- **Selfless Living:** Putting others first, just as Jesus put us first.
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V. SUMMARY: THE ASSURANCE

Security: God's love gives us assurance that we are never abandoned, even in difficult times.

- **Purpose:** It validates our existence. We matter because we are loved by the King of the Universe.
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VI. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions:

1. **Theological Debate:** "If God loves everyone, why does John 3:18 say some are 'condemned already'?" Discuss the role of *belief* as the key to unlocking the benefits of God's love.
2. **Comparative Analysis:** Compare the "Love of God" (Agape) with the typical portrayal of love in modern movies or music. How are they different?
3. **Personal Reflection:** How does knowing you are "made in God's image" change how you view yourself when you feel low or insecure?

B. Objective Revision:

1. According to the lesson, man was the only creature created in God's _____. (*Answer: Image*)
2. John 3:17 states that God sent His Son into the world not to _____ the world, but to save it. (*Answer: Condemn*)
3. List three ways a Christian can practically respond to God's love. (*Answer: Love God, Love others, Obey commands*)

C. Assignment:

- **Reflective Essay (100 words):** "How I Experience God's Love in My Life Today." Students should focus on a specific event or daily reality where they feel God's care.
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VII. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Illustration:** Use the story of a parent sacrificing for a child to illustrate "sacrificial love," then magnify it to the infinite scale of God sacrificing His Son.

Key Distinction: Ensure students understand that God's love is **unconditional** (He loves us as we are) but salvation is **conditional** (we must believe to receive it).

- **Class Activity:** Have students write down one thing they "love" (e.g., pizza, football) and one person they "love." Discuss the difference in the word "love" in those two contexts to introduce *Agape*.



WEEK 9: GOD'S LOVE FOR ONE ANOTHER (BROTHERLY LOVE)

Theme: The Badge of Discipleship

Biblical Texts: John 13:34–35; 1 John 4:7–8, 11–12; 1 John 3:17–18.

Duration: 1 Week

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. **Define** Christian love as distinct from mere emotion, focusing on its selfless and sacrificial nature.
 2. **Analyze** the "New Commandment" in John 13:34–35 and explain *why* it is considered "new."
 3. **Evaluate** the importance of love as the primary evidence of a believer's relationship with God.
 4. **Demonstrate** practical ways to show love in a school and community setting (forgiveness, sharing, intercession).
-

II. PART 1: THE MEANING AND MANDATE OF LOVE

Biblical Focus: John 13:34–35

1. Defining True Love

- **Not Just a Feeling:** In the Christian context, love is not merely a warm emotion. It is **selfless, sacrificial, and unconditional care** for others.

A Command, Not a Suggestion: Love is a direct command from God. This means we are required to act lovingly even when we do not *feel* loving.

Action-Oriented: It involves putting others' needs before our own, forgiving offenses, and actively helping.

2. The "New" Commandment

In the Upper Room, just before His death, Jesus gave a pivotal instruction: *"A new commandment I give to you: that you love one another, as I have loved you"*.

- **The Standard Shift:** The Old Testament command was "Love your neighbor *as yourself*" (Leviticus 19:18). The New Commandment raises the bar: "Love one another *as I have loved you*." Since Jesus loved us enough to die for us, our love for others must be sacrificial.

The Badge of Identity: Jesus emphasized that this specific type of love is the **evidence** of being His disciple. Just as a uniform identifies a student, love identifies a Christian.

III. PART 2: THE IMPORTANCE OF LOVING ONE ANOTHER

Biblical Focus: 1 John 4:7–12

Why is this horizontal love so critical to the faith?

1. **Proof of Relationship with God:** The Bible states that "God is love." Therefore, demonstrating love proves that a person knows God. A hateful Christian is a contradiction in terms.

Evangelism (Attracting Others): Love inspires others to follow Christ. When the world sees a community that loves genuinely—crossing racial and social barriers—it attracts people to God.

Conflict Resolution: Love promotes forgiveness and reconciliation. It covers a multitude of sins and builds peaceful communities by reducing conflict.

Fulfillment of the Law: All religious laws and rules are fulfilled in the single command to love (Romans 13:10).

IV. PART 3: PRACTICAL EXPRESSIONS OF LOVE

Biblical Focus: 1 John 3:17–18

Love must be "genuine, practical, and universal". It includes loving even those who are difficult or different.

1. Emotional & Spiritual Support

Forgiveness: Letting go of grudges against those who offend us.

Intercession: Praying for others, especially those in trouble.

Encouragement: Using words to build people up rather than tear them down.

2. Material & Physical Support

Sharing Resources: Sharing gifts, money, talents, skills, and facilities with those in need.

Compassion: Being considerate of others' feelings and circumstances.

Classroom Scenario Discussion:

- *Scenario:* A classmate loses their textbook and cannot study for a test.
- *Loving Response:* Sharing your book or helping them study, rather than ignoring their struggle.

V. SUMMARY: THE EVIDENCE OF FAITH

- **The Core Truth:** You cannot claim to love the God you cannot see if you hate the brother you can see.
- **The Challenge:** We are called to love not just our friends, but "one another"—the entire community of believers and neighbors.

VI. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions:

1. **Comparative Analysis:** How does Jesus' command to "love as I have loved you" differ from the golden rule "treat others as you want to be treated"? Which is harder?
2. **Contextual Application:** 1 John 3:17 asks, "If anyone has material possessions and sees a brother in need but has no pity on him, how can the love of God be in him?" Apply this verse to the issue of poverty in our society.
3. **Self-Reflection:** Why did Jesus say that love is the primary way people will know we are His disciples (rather than our miracles, preaching, or dressing)?

B. Objective Revision:

1. Complete the verse: "A new commandment I give to you: that you love one another, as I have ____." (*Answer: Loved you*)
2. According to the lesson, love is not just an emotion but a ____ from God. (*Answer: Command*)
3. List two negative things that love helps to reduce in a community. (*Answer: Conflict, disunity/lack of peace*)

C. Assignment:

- **Short Essay (80–100 words):** "The Importance of Loving Others in My School."
Students should discuss how bullying or cliques would disappear if everyone followed the command to love.

VII. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Visual Aid:** Draw a triangle on the board. Label the top "God" and the two bottom corners "You" and "Others." Show that as you move closer to God (up the triangle), you automatically move closer to Others. You cannot have one without the other.

Key Definition: Ensure students understand that "Universal" love means loving people of different tribes, social classes, and even those who are not popular.

- **Activity:** "Secret Angel." Assign every student a classmate to secretly do an act of kindness for during the week (e.g., leaving a nice note, helping with a task). Reveal it in the next class.

WEEK 10: JUSTIFICATION BY FAITH

Theme: Acquittal in the Divine Courtroom

Biblical Texts: Romans 3:21–24, 5:1–11.

Duration: 1 Week

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. **Define** "Justification" using the legal analogy of a courtroom acquittal.
 2. **Contrast** "Justification by Law/Works" (human effort) with "Justification by Faith" (God's grace).
 3. **Identify** the specific conditions required to receive justification (Faith, Repentance, Grace).
 4. **Analyze** the benefits ("fruits") of being justified, specifically how it changes a believer's relationship with suffering and the future.
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II. PART 1: THE MEANING AND NECESSITY OF JUSTIFICATION

Biblical Focus: Romans 3:21–24

1. The Legal Definition

Literal Meaning: To "justify" means to prove right or to declare innocent.

- **The Courtroom Analogy:** Imagine a person accused of a serious crime standing before a judge.
- If, after the investigation, the judge pronounces them "Not Guilty" and sets them free, they have been **justified**.

Theological Definition: Justification is the situation where a sinner is declared innocent and set free from the charge of sin through a legal process established by God.

2. The Need for Justification

Human Failure: Man cannot attain the righteousness of God by his own efforts or by trying to keep the religious law. Human effort always falls short because everyone has sinned.

- **Divine Intervention:** Because of God's love, He intervened. He sent His Son, Jesus, to redeem humanity. Justification is God's solution to man's inability to save himself.

III. PART 2: THE PROCESS – HOW ARE WE JUSTIFIED?

Biblical Focus: Romans 3:22–24

1. The Basis: Grace (God's Part)

- **Unmerited Favor:** Justification is acquired only by **Grace**. Grace is defined as "unmerited favor"—receiving a gift you do not deserve.
- **Redemption:** The price of this freedom was the blood of Jesus shed on the cross. We are justified because Jesus paid the penalty we owed.

2. The Condition: Faith (Man's Part)

Belief, Not Work: A person is justified when they have faith that Jesus died for their sins. It is righteousness acquired *through* faith in Jesus Christ, not through moral perfection.

- **Conditions for Justification:**

Faith in Jesus Christ: Strong trust in His redemptive work.

Repentance: Turning away from sin.

Confession and Acceptance: Verbally acknowledging sin and accepting Jesus as personal Lord and Savior.

IV. PART 3: THE FRUITS AND SIGNIFICANCE

Biblical Focus: Romans 5:1–11

Once a person is declared "Not Guilty," their life changes immediately. Paul lists these benefits as the "Fruits of Justification."

1. Peace with God

- The primary fruit is **Peace**. The war between the sinner and a holy God is over. The justified person is no longer an enemy but a friend.

Freedom: There is no longer any eternal condemnation or guilt hanging over the believer.

2. Access to Grace

- The believer now has standing (access) in God's grace and glory. The door to God's presence is open.

3. Joy in Suffering (Resilience)

- This is a profound paradox. A justified person can rejoice even in suffering. Why? Because suffering is no longer a punishment, but a tool for growth.

The Chain Reaction: Suffering produces **Endurance** → Endurance produces **Character** → Character produces **Hope**.

4. Significance for Today

- **Assurance:** Salvation depends on God's promise, not human effort. This gives believers **assurance**—they don't have to worry if they are "good enough" because Jesus is enough.

Freedom from Law: Christians know they are no longer under the strict burden of the Law but under Grace.

V. SUMMARY: THE GREAT EXCHANGE

- **The Exchange:** Jesus took our guilt; we took His righteousness.

The Result: We are considered righteous not because we act perfect, but because we are "in Christ".

VI. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions:

1. **Analogy:** If you pay a fine for a traffic ticket, you are "free." But if the Judge pays the fine for you, that is "Grace." Discuss how this applies to the death of Jesus.
2. **Self-Reflection:** Why do many people find it hard to accept "Justification by Faith"? Why do we prefer to try and "earn" our way to heaven?
3. **Textual Analysis:** Romans 5 mentions that suffering produces "character." How does knowing you are already "justified" change how you handle a bad situation like failing an exam or being insulted?

B. Objective Revision:

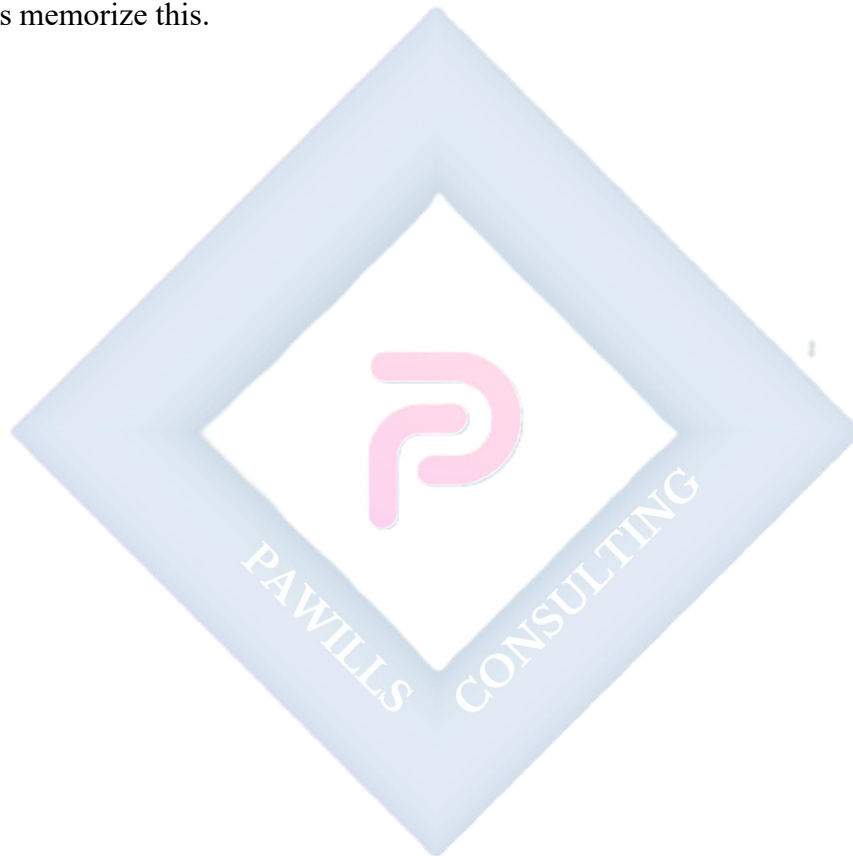
1. Define "Justification" in one sentence based on the lesson. (*Answer: To be declared innocent or set free from a charge*).
2. According to Romans 5, suffering produces endurance, and endurance produces what? (*Answer: Character*).
3. Man cannot attain righteousness by his own effort. It is only by God's _____. (*Answer: Grace*).
4. True or False: Justification is based on how well a person keeps the religious laws. (*Answer: False*).

C. Assignment:

- **Case Study:** Write a short paragraph about a "prisoner" who is set free by a judge even though they were guilty. Use the words **Grace**, **Faith**, and **Justification** to explain the story.
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VII. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Visual Aid:** Use a "Judge's Gavel" prop. Slam it on the desk and say "Guilty!" then explain the penalty. Then slam it and say "Acquitted!" to explain Justification.
- **Key Distinction:** Make sure students understand the difference between **Justification** (a one-time legal declaration of innocence) and **Sanctification** (the daily process of becoming good). This lesson focuses on the *status* change.
- **Vocabulary Check:** "Unmerited Favor" is the classic definition of Grace. Ensure students memorize this.



CHRISTIAN RELIGIOUS STUDIES LESSON

NOTES

SECOND TERM

- 1 New Life in Christ
- 2 Sonship
- 3 Faith and Work
- 4 The fruit of the Spirit
- 5 Midterm Examination
- 6 Spiritual Gifts
- 7 Midterm break
- 8 Forgiveness
- 9 Humility



WEEK 1: NEW LIFE IN CHRIST

Theme: Spiritual Metamorphosis and Identity

Biblical Texts: 2 Corinthians 5:17; Colossians 3:1–17; Romans 6:3–4; John 3:1–5.

Duration: 1 Week

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

Define "New Life in Christ" as a spiritual transformation rather than just a behavioral adjustment.

Analyze the symbolism of **Baptism by Immersion** (Burial and Resurrection).

Contrast the "Old Life" (flesh/sin) with the "New Life" (Spirit/righteousness) using Paul's teachings.

List the practical steps required to be administered into this new life.

II. PART 1: THE MEANING AND SYMBOLISM

Biblical Focus: 2 Corinthians 5:17; Romans 6:3–4

1. What is "New Life"?

Definition: New Life in Christ is a profound **spiritual transformation** that occurs when a person accepts Jesus Christ as their personal Lord and Savior.

- **The Shift:** It involves a fundamental change in character, values, and priorities. It is a process of "dying" to sin and beginning to "live" in righteousness through the power of the Holy Spirit.

Scriptural Basis: Paul declares in 2 Corinthians 5:17: *"Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation; old things have passed away; behold, all things have become new"*. The new life begins in the mind and requires the creative power of God.

2. The Role of Baptism

Paul emphasizes the sacrament of baptism as the public declaration of this union with Christ.

- **Symbolism of Immersion:**
- **Going Under (Burial):** When the believer is immersed in water, it symbolizes being **buried with Christ**. The "old self" dies.

Coming Up (Resurrection): Rising out of the water symbolizes **resurrecting with Christ** into a newness of life.

III. PART 2: CHARACTERISTICS OF THE NEW LIFE

Biblical Focus: Colossians 3:1–17

Paul uses the metaphor of changing clothes—taking off dirty garments and putting on clean ones—to describe this life.

1. "Putting Off" The Old Life (Vices)

Having acquired a new life, the believer must rid themselves of specific negative behaviors. These are characteristic of the "Old Life":

Social Vices: Anger, rage, malice, slander, and filthy language.

Deception: Lying to one another.

Fleshly Desires: Sexual immorality and evil desires.

2. "Putting On" The New Life (Virtues)

The new life is distinguished by specific virtues that reflect Christ.

Interpersonal Virtues: Compassion, kindness, humility, gentleness, and patience.

Key Requirement: Forgiveness ("Forgive as the Lord forgave you") and **Love**, which binds them all together in perfect unity.

Inner State: The "Peace of Christ" should rule in the heart.

Focus: The mind should be set on "things above," not on earthly things.

3. Comparison Table: Old vs. New

This table helps visualize the transformation:

Aspect	The Old Life (Before Christ)	The New Life (In Christ)
Source of Control	Controlled by Flesh/Self	Led by the Holy Spirit
Behavior	Sinful desires, Disobedience	Holiness, Righteousness, Obedience
Relationships	Hatred, Bitterness, Selfishness	Love, Kindness, Forgiveness
Emotional State	Fear and Anxiety	Peace and Assurance

IV. PART 3: STEPS AND CHALLENGES

1. Steps to Entering the New Life

A person does not stumble into this life; they must take deliberate steps:

Hear: Listen to the Word of God.

Confess: Acknowledge sins honestly.

Repent: Turn away from sin and be baptized.

Determine: Make a conscious decision to live a Christ-like life and join the body of believers.

2. The Role of the Holy Spirit

The New Life is impossible to live by human willpower alone. The Holy Spirit is essential because He:

Empowers the believer to resist sin.

Guides and teaches truth (John 14:26).

Produces spiritual fruit.

3. Challenges to Expect

Students must be realistic. Living the new life will attract:

Temptation: Pressure from the world and peers to return to old habits.

Persecution: Ridicule or mockery for being "different".

Internal Struggles: Fighting against old habits.

V. SUMMARY: THE REWARD

Despite the challenges, the New Life offers benefits that the world cannot give:

Assurance of salvation and eternal life.

Peace with God and fellow humans.

Divine Guidance and blessings in daily endeavors.

VI. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions:

1. **Metaphor Analysis:** Paul speaks of "setting your mind on things above" (Col 3:2). How does a student practically do this during a school week filled with exams and peer pressure?
2. **Theological Application:** Explain why "baptism" is described as a *symbol* of the new life. Can a person be baptized but not actually have the "new life"? (Discuss the difference between the ritual and the heart change).
3. **Self-Reflection:** Look at the list of "Vices" to put off (anger, lying, slander). Which of these is most common in your school environment, and how does the New Life cure it?

B. Objective Revision:

1. According to Colossians 3, believers should set their minds on things _____. (*Answer: Above*)

2. Baptism by immersion symbolizes two events in Christ's life: His ____ and His _____. (*Answer: Burial and Resurrection*)
3. "If anyone is in Christ, he is a new _____." (*Answer: Creation*)
4. List three virtues that characterize the New Life. (*Answer: Compassion, Kindness, Humility, Gentleness, Patience, Forgiveness, Love - any three*)

C. Assignment:

- **Personal Essay (1 Page):** "How I can live the New Life in Christ as a student." Focus on specific changes in study habits, language, and relationships with teachers/friends.
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VII. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Visual Aid:** Bring two shirts—one dirty/stained and one clean/white. Have a student "put on" the dirty shirt (Old Life) and then exchange it for the clean one (New Life) to visualize Colossians 3.
- **Differentiation:** For younger students, focus on the "Change of Clothes" analogy. For older students, discuss the *psychology* of the "Renewed Mind" mentioned in Colossians 3:10.
- **Key Concept:** Emphasize that "New Life" is a *process* (Sanctification). We are "new" instantly at salvation, but we "renew" our minds daily.

WEEK 2: SONSHIP

Theme: Adoption, Intimacy, and Inheritance

Biblical Texts: Romans 8:14–17; Galatians 3:26–29, 4:1–7.

Duration: 1 Week

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. **Distinguish** between being a biological creature of God and a spiritual "Son" of God.
 2. **Explain** the transition from "slavery" (under the law) to "sonship" (under grace) as taught by Paul.
 3. **Analyze** the significance of the Aramaic cry "*Abba! Father!*"
 4. **Identify** the responsibilities that accompany the privilege of being an heir to God's kingdom.
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II. PART 1: THE MEANING OF SONSHIP

Biblical Focus: Romans 8:14–17

1. Creation vs. Relationship

The General View: In a literal sense, all human beings are "children of God" because He created them.

- **The Spiritual Reality:** However, the Bible makes a distinction. The special status of "Sonship" is a relational privilege that depends on obedience.

The Fall: Through disobedience (Adam), humanity lost the intimate privilege of being called God's children. We became estranged, like rebels.

The Restoration: Jesus Christ came and obeyed the law perfectly to qualify humanity to be reinstated as children of God.

2. The Concept of "Adoption"

Paul uses the legal term *adoption* to explain our new status. In Roman law, an adopted son had the exact same rights as a biological son.

- **The Spirit of Adoption:** We are not born as God's spiritual children; we are adopted. God sends the "Spirit of His Son" into our hearts.
- **"Abba! Father!":** This is the proof of sonship. "Abba" is an Aramaic term of endearment, similar to "Daddy" or "Papa." It signifies a relationship of deep intimacy, not fear.

III. PART 2: PAUL'S TEACHING TO THE GALATIANS

Biblical Focus: Galatians 3:26–29; 4:1–7

1. From Slaves to Sons

Paul uses an illustration of a child heir to explain the history of Israel and the believer:

The Minor (Slave): Before Christ came, humanity was like a child who is technically an heir but is treated no differently than a slave. We were "slaves to the elemental spirits of the universe" (bound by strict laws and rituals).

The Full Heir (Son): "When the time had fully come," God sent Jesus to redeem those under the law. This allows us to receive full adoption.

The Result: Through God, the believer is no longer a slave but a son, and if a son, then an **heir**.

2. Unity in Sonship

In the family of God, earthly distinctions disappear.

Baptism as Entry: Paul teaches that those who are baptized into Christ have "put on Christ" like a garment.

Equality: Because we are all "in Christ," there is no longer any discrimination—no Jew or Greek, slave or free, male or female.

Abraham's Offspring: If you belong to Christ, you are Abraham's seed and an heir according to the promise.

IV. PART 3: THE EVIDENCE AND DUTIES OF SONSHIP

Biblical Focus: Romans 8:14

Being a "Son" is not just a title; it is a responsibility.

1. *Led by the Spirit*

- The Bible defines sons clearly: *"For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, these are sons of God"* (Romans 8:14). Sonship is evidenced by following God's direction, not fleshly desires.

2. *Obedience and Obligation*

- Just as Jesus obeyed the Father, true sons must obey and fulfill their Christian obligations. This includes civic duties (state obligations) and spiritual duties.
- Disobedience breaks the fellowship (though not necessarily the relationship) with the Father.

3. *Contributing to the Kingdom*

Evangelism: Sons strive hard to win more souls for Christ. A son cares about his Father's business.

Stewardship: Sons contribute their "quota in cash and kind" towards the propagation of the Gospel. They invest in the family business (the Church).

V. SUMMARY: THE PRIVILEGE

- **Past:** We were slaves to fear and the law.

- **Present:** We are adopted sons crying "Abba, Father."
 - **Future:** We are heirs—everything that belongs to Jesus belongs to us by inheritance.
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VI. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions:

1. **Analogy Analysis:** Paul compares the Old Testament law to a "guardian" or "tutor" that managed us while we were minors. How does this help explain why Christians don't follow all the Jewish ceremonial laws today?
2. **Cultural Application:** In many cultures, adopted children are seen as "second-class." How does the Biblical view of adoption (Romans 8) contradict this cultural stigma?
3. **Self-Reflection:** Do you relate to God more as a "Slave" (obeying out of fear of punishment) or as a "Son" (obeying out of love and relationship)?

B. Objective Revision:

1. According to the lesson, humanity initially lost the privilege of being God's children due to _____. (*Answer: Disobedience*)
2. What Aramaic word does the Spirit cry out in our hearts to show we are God's children? (*Answer: Abba*)
3. Paul teaches that if we are children, then we are also _____ of God. (*Answer: Heirs*)
4. According to Galatians 3, how does one "put on Christ"? (*Answer: Through baptism*)

C. Assignment:

- **Scripture Journal:** Read Galatians 4:7. Write a letter to God addressing Him as "Abba." In the letter, thank Him for three specific "inheritances" (blessings) you have received because you are His child.
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VII. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Key Terminology:** Ensure students understand that "**Son**" in the Bible (Gr. *Huios*) describes *spiritual maturity* and *legal standing*, and it applies to both men and women. It is not about gender; it is about inheritance rights.
- **Visual Aid:** Draw a timeline on the board. **Left Side:** "Minor/Child" (Under Guardians/Rules). **Cross in the Middle.** **Right Side:** "Adult Son" (Freedom/Spirit). This visualizes Galatians 4.
- **Differentiation:** For advanced students, discuss the difference between "Natural Rights" (Creation) and "Covenant Rights" (Adoption).



WEEK 3: FAITH AND WORKS

Theme: The Evidence of Genuine Salvation

Biblical Texts: James 1:22–27, 2:14–26.

Duration: 1 Week

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. **Define** "Faith" and "Works" and explain their interdependence.
 2. **Differentiate** between "Intellectual Faith" (Mental Assent) and "Saving Faith" (Active Trust).
 3. **Analyze** the three illustrations used by St. James: The Mirror, The Demons, and The Body.
 4. **Demonstrate** how to convert spiritual belief into practical social action (e.g., caring for orphans/widows).
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II. PART 1: THE CONCEPTS DEFINED

Biblical Focus: James 1:22–25

1. Meaning of Faith

Definition: Faith means trust or belief. It is not just agreeing with facts in your head; it is "relegating oneself to God in trust and self-abnegation".

Biblical Context: It involves recognizing and accepting the historic events of Jesus Christ (His death and resurrection) as true and personal.

2. Meaning of Works

Definition: Works are the "manifestation in practical terms" of faith, belief, and scriptural doctrine.

- **The Connection:** Works are the visible evidence of an invisible faith. Just as smoke proves there is fire, works prove there is faith.

3. The "Hearer" vs. The "Doer" (The Mirror Analogy)

James 1 compares the Word of God to a mirror.

- **The Hearer Only:** A person who listens to the sermon but does nothing is like a man who looks in a mirror, sees his dirty face, walks away, and immediately forgets what he looks like. He deceives himself.
- **The Doer:** A person who looks into the perfect law of liberty and *acts* on it. This person is blessed in what they do.

III. PART 2: ST. JAMES' TEACHING ON FAITH AND WORKS

Biblical Focus: James 2:14–26

James argues that "faith by itself, if it does not have works, is dead." He uses three powerful arguments to prove this.

1. The Intellectual Argument (Demons)

- **Intellectual Faith:** James recognizes a type of faith that is purely mental. He points out that "even the demons believe—and shudder!" (James 2:19).

The Lesson: Demons accept the reality of God as a fact, but they do not submit to Him or change their nature. Therefore, simply "believing God exists" is not enough to save anyone. True faith involves conscious surrender.

2. The Historical Argument (Abraham)

- **Abraham's Test:** Abraham is acclaimed as "God's friend" and the father of faith. However, James notes that he was justified by works when he offered his son Isaac on the altar.

Faith in Action: Abraham's faith was not just a feeling; it was "completed" by his works. He proved he believed God by obeying God, even when it was difficult.

3. The Physiological Argument (The Body)

The Analogy: *"For as the body apart from the spirit is dead, so faith apart from works is dead"* (James 2:26).

- **Implication:** You cannot have a living human being without a spirit (breath). Similarly, you cannot have a living Christian faith without active works.
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IV. PART 3: RECONCILING PAUL AND JAMES

Students often find this confusing: Paul says we are saved by *faith alone* (Eph 2:8), while James says *faith without works* is dead.

- **Complementary Truths:** They are not fighting; they are fighting different enemies.
- **Paul** is fighting **Legalism** (the idea that you can earn heaven by doing good deeds). He emphasizes the **Root** of salvation (Faith).
- **James** is fighting **Laziness** (the idea that you can live in sin just because you "believe"). He emphasizes the **Fruit** of salvation (Works).
- **Conclusion:** We are saved by faith alone, but the faith that saves is never alone—it is always accompanied by good works.

Practical Christianity (James 1:27)

James defines "pure religion" in two practical ways:

1. **Social Responsibility:** To visit orphans and widows in their affliction. This means caring for the vulnerable in society.
 2. **Moral Purity:** To keep oneself unstained from the world.
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V. SUMMARY: VISIBLE EVIDENCE

Tangibility: Works are more tangible than faith because they have physical representation.

- **Demonstration:** Faith is invisible; works are visible. It is impossible for someone to "see" your faith unless they see your works.

Completeness: Faith is incomplete until physically demonstrated.

VI. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions:

1. **Scenario Analysis:** If a man sees a hungry brother and says, "Go in peace, be warmed and filled," but gives him no food, what kind of faith does this man have? (James 2:15-16).
2. **Comparative Analysis:** Compare the "faith" of a demon (James 2:19) with the "faith" of Abraham (James 2:21). What is the key difference?
3. **Self-Reflection:** James says be "doers of the word, and not hearers only." List three things you have *heard* in church/school recently. Have you *done* them?

B. Objective Revision:

1. According to James, faith without works is _____. (*Answer: Dead*)
2. Who is the Old Testament patriarch James uses as an example of faith working together with deeds? (*Answer: Abraham*)
3. James defines pure religion as visiting orphans and widows and keeping oneself _____ from the world. (*Answer: Unstained/Unspotted*)

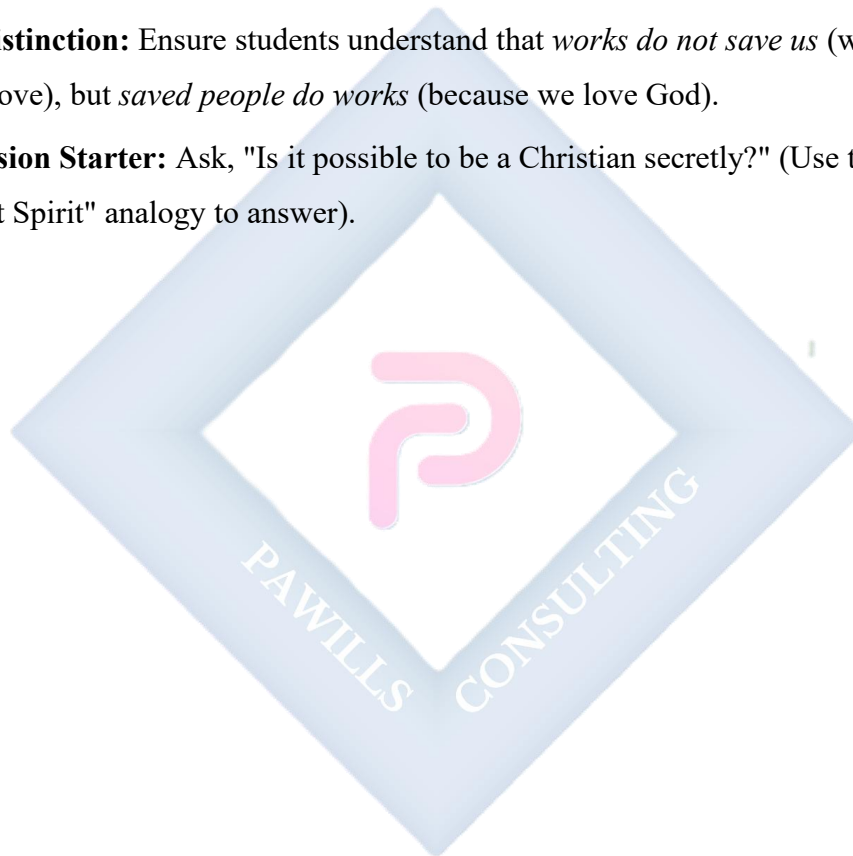
C. Assignment:

- **Action Project:** "Faith in Action Week." Identify one person in your neighborhood or school who is in need (lonely, hungry, or struggling with studies). Perform one specific

"work" this week to help them, and write a paragraph on how this action "completed" your faith.

VII. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Visual Aid:** Bring a flashlight without batteries. Show the students that the flashlight looks perfect on the outside (Intellectual Faith), but without batteries (Works/Action), it produces no light.
- **Key Distinction:** Ensure students understand that *works do not save us* (we don't buy God's love), but *saved people do works* (because we love God).
- **Discussion Starter:** Ask, "Is it possible to be a Christian secretly?" (Use the "Body without Spirit" analogy to answer).



WEEK 4: THE FRUIT OF THE SPIRIT

Theme: Character Formation and Spiritual Evidence

Biblical Texts: Galatians 5:22–25; Galatians 5:19–21; Acts 2:3–8; Romans 10:9–10.

Duration: 1 Week

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. **Define** "Fruit of the Spirit" and explain why the Bible uses the agricultural metaphor of "fruit" rather than "machines" or "products."
 2. **Contrast** the "Works of the Flesh" (human effort/sin) with the "Fruit of the Spirit" (divine production).
 3. **Analyze** how all nine attributes emanate from **Love**.
 4. **Evaluate** the necessity of the Holy Spirit in producing this character, referencing Pentecost (Acts 2).
-

II. PART 1: DEFINITION AND NATURE

Biblical Focus: Galatians 5:22–23

1. The Metaphor of Fruit

Literal Meaning: Fruits are the natural produce of plants or trees. They contain seeds, allowing for reproduction, and they usually serve as food.

Spiritual Meaning: In a religious sense, the "Fruit of the Spirit" refers to the inherent features or habits of a good Christian. It is the visible evidence that the light of God is shining in a believer.

Singular vs. Plural: Paul uses the singular word "Fruit" (not fruits) to describe nine attributes. This implies they are not separate virtues to be picked one by one, but a unified "cluster" of character traits. You cannot truly have patience without love, nor peace without self-control.

2. The Foundation: Love

The Source: The source note emphasizes that "the entire nine fruit of the spirit emanate from LOVE".

- **The Logic:** Love is the root.
- **Joy** is love rejoicing.
- **Peace** is love resting.
- **Patience** is love enduring.
- **Kindness** is love serving.
- *If a Christian lacks love, they lack the entire fruit.*

III. PART 2: THE CONFLICT – FLESH VS. SPIRIT

Biblical Focus: Galatians 5:19–21

Paul contrasts the fruit with the "Works of the Flesh." Note the change in terminology: The flesh produces "works" (effort, grinding, labor), while the Spirit produces "fruit" (natural growth).

1. The Works of the Flesh

These are habits not expected from Christians. They are manifestations of the devil. They can be categorized into three groups:

Sexual Sins: Adultery, fornication, uncleanness, lasciviousness.

Religious Sins: Idolatry, witchcraft.

Social Sins: Hatred, variance (discord), wrath, strife, sedition, envy, murder, drunkenness.

2. The Warning

People who live according to the flesh exhibit these traits. The Bible warns that those who practice such things will not inherit the Kingdom of God.

IV. PART 3: HOW TO BEAR FRUIT

Biblical Focus: Romans 10:9–10; Acts 2:3–8

Fruit cannot be forced; it must be grown. The lesson outlines two major steps to bearing spiritual fruit:

1. Salvation (*Connection to the Life Source*)

Confession: One must confess with their lips that Jesus is Lord and believe in their heart that God raised Him from the dead.

Justification: Believing with the heart leads to justification, and confessing with the mouth leads to salvation. *Without this root connection, no fruit is possible.*

2. Indwelling of the Holy Spirit (*Power*)

- **The Pentecost Experience:** Just as the disciples needed the Spirit at Pentecost, believers need the Holy Spirit today. In Acts 2:3–8, tongues of fire rested on them, and they were filled with the Holy Spirit.

The Evidence: The fruit of the Spirit is the essential evidence of a Christian life. If a person claims to be a Christian but does not exhibit this fruit (character), their salvation is questionable.

V. SUMMARY: CHARACTER OVER CHARISMA

- **The Distinction:** While "Gifts" (which we will study later) show the *power* of God, "Fruit" shows the *character* of God.
 - **The Necessity:** A tree is known by its fruit. A Christian is known not by how loud they pray, but by their love, patience, and self-control.
-

VI. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions:

1. **Theological Analysis:** Why does Paul call them "Works" of the flesh (plural) but "Fruit" of the Spirit (singular)? What does this teach us about the unity of Christian character?
2. **Case Study:** A student is very gifted at singing in the choir (Talent) but is often rude, arrogant, and refuses to follow instructions (Lack of Fruit). Based on Galatians 5, discuss the spiritual health of this student.
3. **Scriptural Application:** Romans 10:9-10 emphasizes "Heart Belief" and "Mouth Confession." Why are both necessary for the new life that produces fruit?

B. Objective Revision:

1. According to the lesson, the nine attributes of the Spirit all emanate from one primary virtue. What is it? *(Answer: Love).*
2. List three "Works of the Flesh" mentioned in Galatians 5. *(Answer: Adultery, idolatry, murder, etc.).*
3. True or False: The fruit of the Spirit is the essential evidence of a Christian life. *(Answer: True).*
4. In Acts 2, what physical symbol appeared on the disciples when they received the Holy Spirit? *(Answer: Tongues as of fire).*

C. Assignment:

- **Self-Examination:** Draw a tree with 9 fruits labeled with the virtues in Galatians 5:22. Color the fruits you see "ripe" in your life Green. Color the ones that are still "growing" or "missing" Yellow. Write a prayer asking the Holy Spirit to help you ripen the yellow fruits.

VII. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Visual Aid:** Bring a basket of different fruits (or plastic fruits). Use a rotten fruit to symbolize "Works of the Flesh" and a fresh fruit to symbolize "Fruit of the Spirit."

- **Key Concept:** Differentiate between **Legality** (Rules) and **Vitality** (Life). The works of the flesh happen when we try to follow rules without the Spirit. The fruit of the Spirit happens when we have the life of God inside us.

Discussion Point: Discuss the statement: *"If a person does not exhibit the fruit of the spirit, then it shows that the salvation of such person is questionable"*. This is a strong statement—allow students to debate and discuss it.



WEEK 6: SPIRITUAL GIFTS

Theme: Equipment for Service and Ministry **Biblical Texts:** 1 Corinthians 12:1–11; Ephesians 4:11–13; Romans 12:3–8. **Duration:** 1 Week

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

5. **Define** "Spiritual Gifts" and distinguish them from natural "Talents."
 6. **Classify** the nine spiritual gifts listed in 1 Corinthians 12 into their three functional categories (Revelation, Power, Utterance).
 7. **Explain** the principles governing the distribution and use of gifts (Sovereignty, Common Good, Unity).
 8. **Evaluate** the purpose of these gifts: not for personal ego, but for the edification of the Church.
-

II. PART 1: DEFINITIONS AND DISTINCTIONS

Biblical Focus: 1 Corinthians 12:4–8; Ephesians 4:11–13

1. What is a Spiritual Gift?

Definition: Spiritual gifts are special abilities or capacities given by the Holy Spirit to believers. They are not natural human abilities but supernatural endowments.

Purpose: They are intended for service and ministry within the Christian community. They are strictly for the building up of the church and furthering God's mission, not for personal gain.

2. Spiritual Gifts vs. Natural Talents

Students often confuse the two. This distinction is vital:

Talents: These are natural or developed skills possessed by a person. They are often inherited or learned through practice (e.g., singing, drawing, dancing, mathematics, craftsmanship).

- **Spiritual Gifts:** These are given by the Spirit *after* salvation for specific spiritual functions (e.g., prophecy, healing).
- **The Connection:** While distinct, both should be used for God's glory. Paul advises Christians not to think too highly of themselves but to use their measure of gifts with "sober judgment".

III. PART 2: THE NINE GIFTS OF THE SPIRIT

Biblical Focus: 1 Corinthians 12:8–10

St. Paul lists nine specific manifestations of the Spirit. These are traditionally categorized into three groups for easier study:

Group A: Revelation Gifts (Gifts that "Know")

These gifts convey information from God to man.

1. **Word of Wisdom:** The ability to understand and apply deep spiritual truths in practical ways. It is supernatural insight into what to *do*.
2. **Word of Knowledge:** The gift of understanding and teaching the mysteries of the faith. It is supernatural insight into facts or truths.
3. **Discernment of Spirits:** The ability to distinguish between good and evil spirits. It allows a believer to recognize the source of a spiritual manifestation (God, Satan, or human spirit).

Group B: Power Gifts (Gifts that "Do")

These gifts demonstrate God's sovereignty over nature and circumstances.

4. **Faith:** A strong, unwavering trust in God that enables one to take bold actions. This is different from saving faith; it is "mountain-moving" faith.

5. **Gifts of Healing:** The ability to heal physical, emotional, or spiritual wounds through God's power.
6. **Working of Miracles:** The ability to perform extraordinary works that demonstrate God's power. These are acts that alter the normal course of nature.

Group C: Utterance/Vocal Gifts (Gifts that "Speak")

These gifts use the tongue to communicate God's message.

7. **Prophecy:** The gift of speaking forth messages from God. It often involves declaring His will to strengthen, encourage, and comfort.
8. **Speaking in Tongues:** The ability to speak in languages unknown to the speaker. It is used for private prayer or, when interpreted, for public worship.
9. **Interpretation of Tongues:** The ability to interpret the meaning of a message spoken in tongues.

IV. PART 3: DISTRIBUTION AND PURPOSE

Biblical Focus: 1 Corinthians 12:7, 11, 12–27

1. How Are They Distributed?

Source: All spiritual gifts come from one source: the Holy Spirit.

- **Universal:** "To Each Believer." Every true Christian receives at least one gift. There are no "ungifted" believers.
- **Sovereign:** "As the Spirit Wills." God decides who gets which gift. We cannot demand specific gifts based on our preference or merit; they are distributed according to His purpose.

2. Why Are They Given? (The Benefits)

- **For the Common Good:** Gifts are never for self-promotion or showing off. They are for the profit of all.

Interdependence: Paul compares the church to a human **Body**.

- Just as a hand needs the eye, believers need each other's diverse gifts.
- No single person has *all* the gifts, which forces us to rely on one another.

Transformation: Exercising these gifts helps believers avoid worldly patterns (conformity) and instead be transformed.

Fulfillment: Using gifts allows believers to fulfill the Great Commission and their personal calling.

V. SUMMARY: UNITY IN DIVERSITY

- **Unity:** There is one Spirit, one Lord, and one God who works all in all.
 - **Diversity:** There are varieties of gifts, services, and activities.
 - **Goal:** To build a mature Church where every part does its share.
-

VI. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions:

1. **Scenario Analysis:** If a church member speaks in tongues loudly during a service but there is no interpreter, based on 1 Corinthians 14 (implied context of "Order"), is this helpful? Why does Paul emphasize "Interpretation" as a companion gift?
2. **Self-Reflection:** Differentiate between your "Talents" (things you are naturally good at) and "Spiritual Gifts" (spiritual abilities). How can you use your natural talent (e.g., singing) to support a spiritual gift (e.g., prophecy or encouragement)?
3. **Theological Debate:** Why does the Holy Spirit distribute gifts "as He wills" rather than letting us choose? How does this prevent pride?

B. Objective Revision:

1. Spiritual gifts are given for the _____ of the church. (*Answer: Edification/Building up*)
2. Which gift involves the ability to distinguish between good and evil spirits? (*Answer: Discernment of Spirits*)

3. True or False: Natural talents and spiritual gifts are exactly the same thing. (*Answer: False*)
4. According to Romans 12:3, Christians should think of themselves with _____ judgment. (*Answer: Sober*)

C. Assignment:

- **Discovery Project:** Write a paragraph identifying one spiritual gift you admire or think you might have. Explain *how* you would use it to help a specific group of people in your school (e.g., "I would use the gift of Wisdom to help friends who are confused about peer pressure").
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VII. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Analogy:** Use the "Human Body" analogy extensively. Ask: "What happens if the Eye tries to do the job of the Hand?" (Confusion/Inefficiency). Use this to explain why we shouldn't be jealous of other people's gifts.
- **Clarification:** Be careful to explain that "Prophecy" is not just predicting the future (foretelling) but also speaking God's truth to a situation (forth-telling).
- **Context:** Remind students that the Corinthian church was very gifted but very immature. Having gifts does not mean you are spiritually mature; having *Fruit* (Week 4) does.

WEEK 8: FORGIVENESS

Theme: Reconciliation and Restoration

Biblical Text: Philemon 1:1–25; Matthew 6:14–15, 18:21–35.

Duration: 1 Week

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. **Define** "Forgiveness" in both secular and biblical terms.
 2. **Analyze** the relationship dynamics between Paul, Philemon, and Onesimus.
 3. **Evaluate** Paul's method of conflict resolution (Intercession) and apply it to modern conflicts.
 4. **Discuss** the spiritual and social consequences of unforgiveness (hatred, disunity) versus the benefits of reconciliation.
-

II. PART 1: THE MEANING OF FORGIVENESS

Biblical Focus: Matthew 6:14–15

1. Definition

Literal Meaning: Forgiveness implies having no further wish to punish someone for an offense committed. It means letting go of ill feelings and the desire for revenge.

- **Biblical Meaning:** In the New Testament, forgiveness is modeled after God's initiative. Just as God restored man to fellowship despite our sin, Christians are called to restore offenders.
- **The Condition:** Jesus taught that our forgiveness from God is linked to our forgiveness of others. If we do not forgive men their trespasses, neither will our Father forgive ours (Matt 6:14–15).

2. The Limit of Forgiveness

- **Unlimited:** There should be no limit to how often Christians forgive. Whether it is "seventy times seven" (Matt 18:22), the principle is that forgiveness is a continuous lifestyle, not a one-time act.

III. PART 2: CASE STUDY – THE LETTER TO PHILEMON

Biblical Focus: Philemon 1

This short letter is a masterclass in Christian diplomacy and love.

1. The Characters and Context

- **Philemon:** A wealthy Christian and leader of a house church in Colossae. He had a reputation for love and faith.
- **Onesimus:** Philemon's runaway slave. Under Roman law, a runaway slave could be punished by death. Onesimus had fled to Rome, where he met Paul and became a Christian (converted).
- **Paul:** The apostle, currently in prison, who acted as the mediator.

2. Paul's Appeal (The Strategy)

Paul did not use his apostolic authority to command Philemon. Instead, he appealed to love.

The Intercession: Paul sent Onesimus back to Philemon, not as a slave, but as a "beloved brother".

- **The Transformation:** Paul highlighted that Onesimus (whose name means "Useful") was formerly useless to Philemon but is now truly useful to both of them.
- **The Guarantee:** Paul offered to pay any debt Onesimus owed: *"If he has wronged you or owes anything, put that on my account"* (Philemon 1:18). *Note: This mirrors what Jesus did for us—taking our debt of sin upon Himself.*

3. The Goal: Restoration

Paul's goal was not just to avoid punishment for Onesimus, but to achieve full **Reconciliation**. He wanted Philemon to receive him back voluntarily, restoring the relationship to one of Christian brotherhood.

IV. PART 3: THE MECHANICS OF FORGIVENESS

1. Three Ways Forgiveness is Achieved

The lesson outlines three scenarios for how forgiveness happens in a community:

Repentance: The offender realizes their mistake and asks for pardon.

Unconditional Mercy: The offended person, motivated by the love of God, voluntarily decides to pardon the offender even without an apology.

Mediation: A third party (like Paul) intervenes to reconcile the two conflicting parties.

2. The Consequences of Unforgiveness

Refusing to forgive is destructive. The negative effects include:

Emotional: Hatred and bitterness take root.

Social: It leads to war, lack of peace, and disunity in families and communities.

Spiritual: It causes spiritual retardation (hindered growth) and blocks our own prayers for forgiveness.

V. SUMMARY: LESSONS FOR BELIEVERS

Intercession: Christians should be peacemakers, interceding for others just as Paul did for Onesimus.

Obedience: By forgiving, we are obeying God's direct commandment.

Rehabilitation: Forgiveness should extend to rehabilitation—helping the offender find their place again in society (as Onesimus was rehabilitated from a runaway to a brother).

VI. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions:

1. **Social Context:** In Roman times, slaves were considered property. How did Paul's request to treat Onesimus as a "brother" challenge the entire social structure of that day?
2. **Modern Application:** Who represents "Onesimus" in our school or society today? (Think of someone who has broken rules or is an outcast). How can we act as "Paul" to help them?
3. **Theological Reflection:** Paul offered to pay Onesimus's debt. How is this similar to the doctrine of "Justification" we studied in Week 10 of the First Term?

B. Objective Revision:

1. Who was the runaway slave mentioned in Paul's epistle? (*Answer: Onesimus*).
2. Paul appealed to Philemon to receive his slave back, no longer as a slave but as a _____. (*Answer: Brother*).
3. According to the lesson, one effect of unforgiveness is lack of _____ and _____. (*Answer: Peace and Unity*).
4. Paul could have commanded Philemon, but he appealed to him for the sake of _____. (*Answer: Love*).

C. Assignment:

- **Conflict Resolution Plan:** Think of a person you are currently in conflict with (or a past conflict). Write a "Letter of Mediation" to yourself from the perspective of Paul, advising you on how to handle the situation using the principles of Philemon.
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VII. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Key Insight:** Emphasize that forgiveness does not always mean "trusting" immediately (e.g., if someone stole money), but it does mean releasing the desire to punish. However, in Philemon's case, Paul asked for *full* restoration of trust.
- **Visual Aid:** Role-play the three characters. Student A (Philemon) sits on a chair (authority). Student B (Onesimus) stands far away (fear). Student C (Paul) stands in the middle, holding the hands of both to bring them together.
- **Biblical Trivia:** Mention that Onesimus likely went on to become a Bishop in the early church, proving that Paul's "rehabilitation" strategy worked.



WEEK 9: HUMILITY

Theme: The Path to Exaltation

Biblical Texts: Philippians 2:1–11; 1 Peter 5:5–11.

Duration: 1 Week

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. **Define** "Humility" as a state of mind rather than just an outward behavior.
 2. **Analyze** the "Kenosis" of Jesus (His self-emptying) as described in Philippians 2.
 3. **Explain** the paradox of the Kingdom: "The way up is down" (God exalts the humble).
 4. **Apply** Peter's instructions on submission and anxiety to their daily relationships with elders and peers.
-

II. PART 1: THE MEANING OF HUMILITY

Biblical Focus: General Introduction

1. Definition

Literal Meaning: Humility is a state of mind depicting a modest opinion of oneself. It is the opposite of pride and arrogance.

Christian Context: It is one of the greatest attributes of a Christian. Without it, a claim to be in Christ is not genuine. It involves recognizing one's dependence on God and valuing others above oneself.

Social Impact: Humility creates understanding, promotes progress, and ensures peace and harmony in society.

III. PART 2: THE SUPREME EXAMPLE (PAUL'S TEACHING)

Biblical Focus: Philippians 2:1–11

1. The Context: Disunity

Paul wrote this letter because there was "great disunity" and friction among the church members in Philippi. He identified the root cause as a lack of humility and selfishness.

2. The Model: The Mind of Christ

Paul used the example of Jesus to teach them how to relate to one another. This passage (Phil 2:5–11) is known as the *Carmen Christi* (Hymn of Christ).

- **Pre-Existence (Status):** Jesus was in the "form of God." He possessed full divinity and equality with God.
- **The Descent (Humiliation):**

Self-Emptying: He did not count equality with God as something to be grasped (held onto for personal gain).

Servanthood: He took the "form of an ordinary servant" and was born in the likeness of man.

Ultimate Obedience: He humbled Himself further by becoming obedient to the point of death—even the shameful death on a **cross**.

3. The Result: Exaltation

Because Jesus went to the lowest point, God raised Him to the highest point.

- "Therefore God has highly exalted Him and given Him a name which is above every other name".

The outcome: At the name of Jesus, every knee must bow, and every tongue confess that Jesus is Lord.

- **Lesson:** The path to true glory is through humble service.
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IV. PART 3: HUMILITY IN COMMUNITY (PETER'S TEACHING)

Biblical Focus: 1 Peter 5:5–11

St. Peter addresses the practical application of humility within the church structure, specifically for the youth.

1. Intergenerational Respect

To the Youth: Peter advises the younger generation to be loyal and submissive to their elders.

To Everyone: All Christians must "clothe themselves with humility" in their dealings with one another. The metaphor "clothe" suggests humility should be worn like a uniform (likely referencing Jesus tying a towel around his waist to wash feet).

2. The Divine Principle

The Law: "God opposes the proud, but gives grace to the humble". Pride sets a person in direct conflict with God.

The Promise: If you humble yourself under God's mighty hand, **He will exalt you in due time.** Promotion comes from God, not from self-promotion.

3. Humility and Anxiety

Peter links humility to trust.

Casting Cares: He instructs believers to "cast all their anxieties on God for He cares for them".

- **The Connection:** Worry is often a form of pride—it implies we think we must solve everything ourselves. Humility admits we need God's help.

4. Spiritual Warfare

The Enemy: Peter warns that Satan prowls around like a "roaring lion seeking someone to devour".

- **The Defense:** Christians must be sober and watchful. Resisting the devil requires firm faith and the humility to endure suffering.

V. SUMMARY: EXPRESSIONS OF HUMILITY

How do we know if a student or leader is humble? The lesson identifies these practical expressions:

Selfless Service: Rendering service to society without seeking applause.

Forgiveness: Letting go of offenses readily.

Law-Abiding: Respecting rules and constituted authority.

Prioritizing Society: Putting the interest of the community above personal gain.

VI. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions:

1. **Paradox Analysis:** "The way up is down." Explain this statement using the life of Jesus (Phil 2) and the teaching of Peter (1 Peter 5).
2. **Cultural Application:** In a world that celebrates "Influencers" and self-promotion, how can a Christian student practice the instruction to "clothe yourselves with humility" without becoming a doormat?
3. **Theological Connection:** Peter says humility helps us resist the devil (1 Peter 5:8–9). Why do you think Pride makes a person vulnerable to Satan's attacks?

B. Objective Revision:

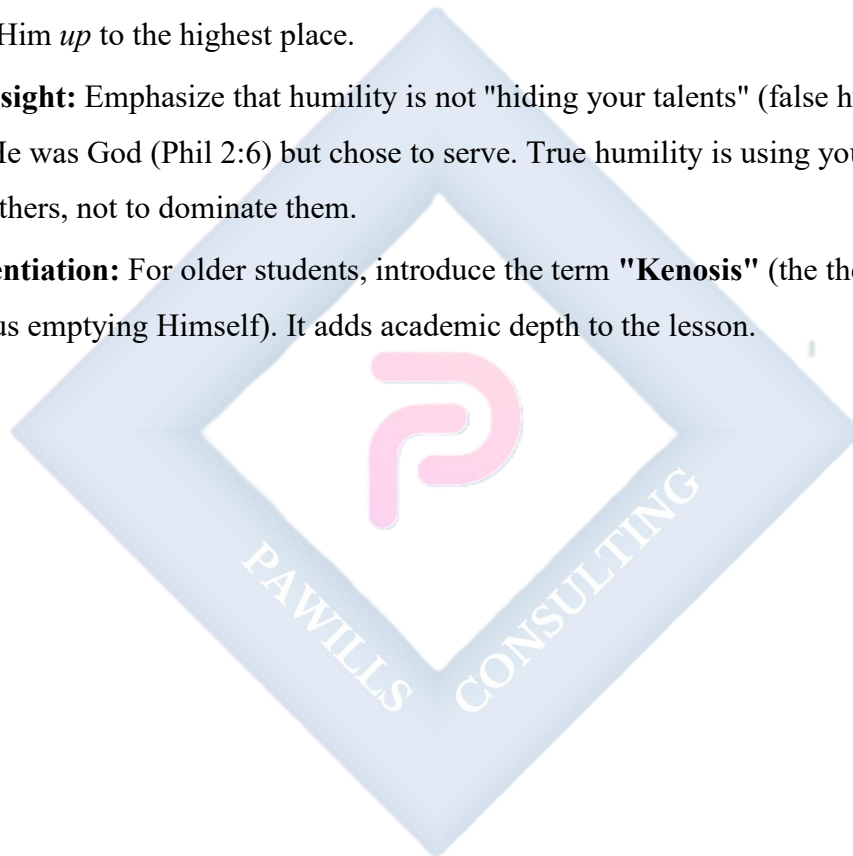
1. According to Philippians 2, Jesus took the form of a _____ and was born in the likeness of men. (*Answer: Servant*)
2. "God opposes the proud but gives _____ to the humble." (*Answer: Grace*)
3. St. Peter describes the devil as a roaring _____ seeking someone to devour. (*Answer: Lion*)
4. Humility is defined as a state of mind depicting a _____ opinion of oneself. (*Answer: Modest*)

C. Assignment:

- **Case Study:** Identify a leader in history or your community who demonstrated humility. Write a short paragraph explaining how their humility helped them succeed or bring peace.
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VII. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Visual Aid:** Use a ladder. Label the bottom rung "Service/Death" and the top rung "Exaltation." Explain that Jesus stepped *down* the ladder from Heaven to Earth, and God pulled Him *up* to the highest place.
- **Key Insight:** Emphasize that humility is not "hiding your talents" (false humility). Jesus knew He was God (Phil 2:6) but chose to serve. True humility is using your power to serve others, not to dominate them.
- **Differentiation:** For older students, introduce the term "**Kenosis**" (the theological term for Jesus emptying Himself). It adds academic depth to the lesson.

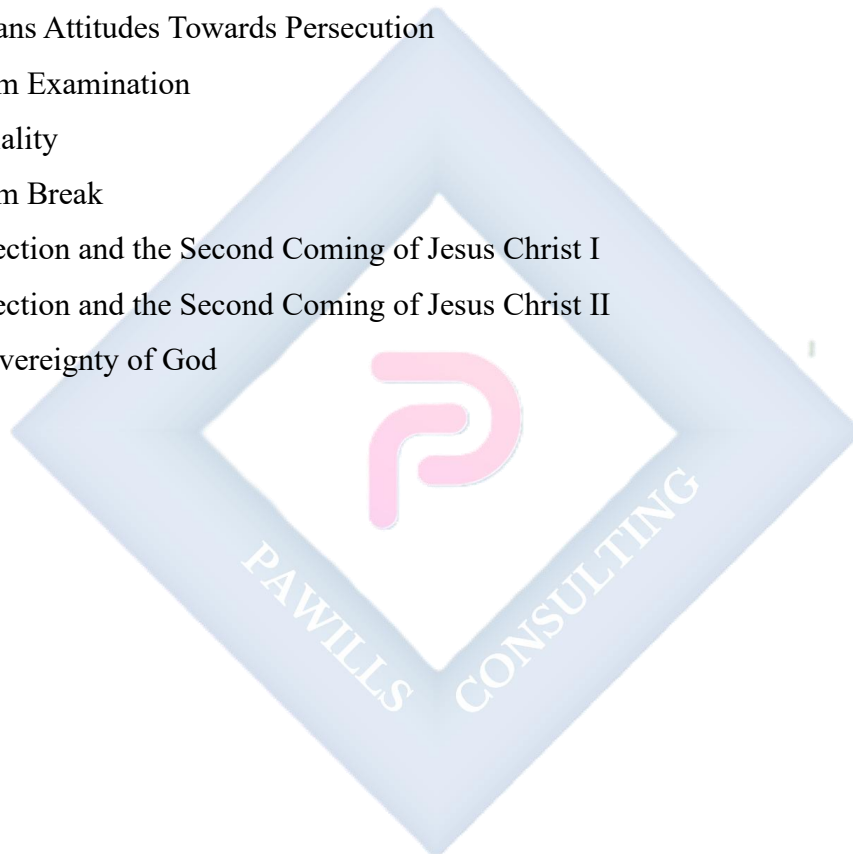


CHRISTIAN RELIGIOUS STUDIES LESSON

NOTES

THIRD TERM

- 1 Effective Prayer
- 2 Living a Life of Witnessing to Christ I
- 3 Living a Life of Witnessing to Christ II
- 4 Christians Attitudes Towards Persecution
- 5 Midterm Examination
- 6 Impartiality
- 7 Midterm Break
- 8 Resurrection and the Second Coming of Jesus Christ I
- 9 Resurrection and the Second Coming of Jesus Christ II
- 10 The Sovereignty of God



WEEK 1: EFFECTIVE PRAYER

Theme: Communication with the Divine

Biblical Texts: James 1:5–8, 4:2–3, 5:13–18; Matthew 6:5–6.

Duration: 1 Week

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. **Define** prayer as "intimate communion" rather than just a religious ritual.
 2. **Analyze** St. James' teaching on prayer regarding faith, wisdom, and healing.
 3. **Classify** the different types of prayer (Adoration, Confession, Petition, etc.).
 4. **Evaluate** the barriers to effective prayer (Doubt, Sin, Wrong Motives) and how to overcome them using the example of Elijah.
-

II. PART 1: THE MEANING AND TEACHING OF JAMES

Biblical Focus: James 1:5–8; 5:13–18

1. What is Effective Prayer?

Definition: Prayer is a personal and intimate communion with God. It is not merely reciting words; it requires "mental concentration and rapt attention".

The Focus: It involves aligning our human will with God's will. Jesus taught that all prayers should be addressed to the Father in His name.

- **"Effective":** An effective prayer is "result-oriented." It is offered by a person who does not doubt God's reality, willingness, or ability to answer.

2. James' Instructions for Different Seasons

St. James provides a comprehensive guide on when and how to pray:

In Lack of Wisdom: If anyone lacks wisdom, they should ask God in faith.

In Suffering: "Is anyone among you suffering? Let him pray".

In Joy: "Is anyone cheerful? Let him sing praise".

In Sickness: "Is anyone among you sick? Let him call for the elders of the church" to pray over him and anoint him with oil.

The Promise: The "prayer of faith" will save the sick, and the Lord will raise him up.

III. PART 2: CONDITIONS AND HINDRANCES

Biblical Focus: James 1:6–8, 4:3

Why do some prayers go unanswered? James identifies specific conditions and obstacles.

1. Conditions for Success

- **Faith (The Engine):** Faith is paramount. We must believe that God exists and hears us.
- **Right Motive (The Steering):** Prayers must spring from the right motive. James warns, *"You ask and do not receive, because you ask wrongly, to spend it on your passions"*. Selfish prayers to satisfy our own ego or lusts are rejected.

Righteousness & Confession: Sin hinders prayer. Therefore, we must confess our sins to God (and to one another) to be healed. The prayer of a sinner is ineffective, but the prayer of a righteous man has great power.

- **Humility/Privacy:** Effective prayer is not an attempt to impress people. James echoes Jesus' teaching to pray in one's "closet" (private room) rather than showing off.

2. Hindrances (The Barriers)

- **Doubt:** A doubting person is unstable "like a wave of the sea" driven by the wind. Such a person should not expect to receive anything from the Lord.

Unforgiveness & Sin: Cherishing sin or refusing to forgive blocks access to God.

Lack of Perseverance: Giving up too soon.

IV. PART 3: TYPES OF PRAYER

Biblical Focus: James 5:13–18

Prayer is not one-dimensional. The lesson identifies several distinct types:

Prayer of Adoration: Praising God for who He is (His nature and holiness).

Prayer of Thanksgiving: Thanking God for what He has done (His goodness, favor, and grace).

Prayer of Confession: Acknowledging sins with a determination to forsake them.

Prayer of Petition: Asking for one's own personal needs.

Prayer of Intercession: Standing in the gap to request help for *others* (e.g., praying for the sick or the nation).

Prayer of Dedication: A promise to remain truly God's own and submit to His will.

V. PART 4: CASE STUDY – ELIJAH

Biblical Focus: James 5:17–18

James uses the prophet Elijah to prove that effective prayer is available to *everyone*, not just "super-saints."

Human Nature: James clarifies that "Elijah was a man of like nature like ourselves" (he had feelings, fears, and weaknesses).

- **The Result:** Yet, he prayed **fervently**.
- First, that it might not rain, and for 3.5 years, it did not.
- Second, he prayed again, and the heaven gave rain.
- **The Lesson:** The power of prayer lies in the God who answers, not the perfection of the person asking—provided they are righteous (in right standing with God).

VI. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions:

1. **Theological Analysis:** James 1:8 describes a doubting man as "double-minded." Why is indecision or doubt considered "instability" in the Christian faith?
2. **Comparative Analysis:** Distinguish between a "Prayer of Petition" and a "Prayer of Intercession." Give a modern example of each relevant to a student (e.g., praying for exam success vs. praying for a sick teacher).
3. **Self-Reflection:** James 4:3 mentions asking with "wrong motives." If a student prays to pass an exam *only* so they can mock a failing friend, will God answer? Explain why based on the lesson.

B. Objective Revision:

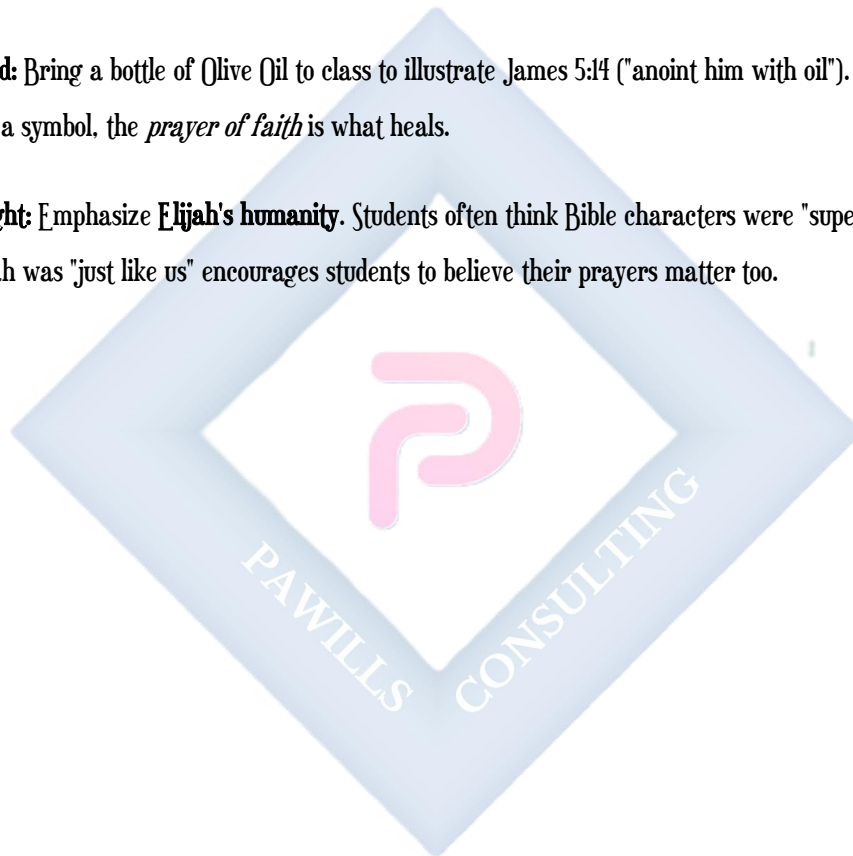
1. According to James, if anyone lacks wisdom, they should ask _____. (*Answer: God*)
2. "The prayer of a _____ man has great power in its effects." (*Answer: Righteous*)
3. Which Old Testament prophet does James mention as an example of effective prayer regarding rain? (*Answer: Elijah*)
4. A person who doubts while praying is compared to a _____ of the sea. (*Answer: Wave*)
5. List two hindrances to effective prayer. (*Answer: Doubt, Sin, Wrong Motives - any two*)

C. Assignment:

- **Prayer Journal:** For the next week, practice the **ACTS** model of prayer (Adoration, Confession, Thanksgiving, Supplication). Write down one sentence for each category every morning.
-

VII. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Acronym Aid:** Teach the students the acronym **ACTS** (Adoration, Confession, Thanksgiving, Supplication) as a memory aid for the Types of Prayer. It perfectly aligns with the content in .
- **Visual Aid:** Bring a bottle of Olive Oil to class to illustrate James 5:14 ("anoint him with oil"). Explain that while the oil is a symbol, the *prayer of faith* is what heals.
- **Key Insight:** Emphasize **Elijah's humanity**. Students often think Bible characters were "superheroes." Stressing that Elijah was "just like us" encourages students to believe their prayers matter too.



WEEK 2 & 3: LIVING A LIFE OF WITNESSING TO CHRIST

Theme: The Christian as a "Silent Sermon"

Biblical Texts: 1 Peter 1:13–17, 2:9–25; Romans 13:1–14.

Duration: 2 Weeks

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this unit, students should be able to:

1. **Define** "Witnessing" as a lifestyle of transparency, accountability, and holiness, rather than just verbal evangelism.
 2. **Analyze** St. Peter's instructions on how Christians should behave among non-believers to silence criticism.
 3. **Evaluate** the Christian's obligation to the State (Civic Responsibility) based on Paul's teaching in Romans 13.
 4. **Distinguish** between "Social Vices" (which hinder witnessing) and "Peaceful Coexistence" (which promotes nation-building).
-

II. PART 1: THE CALL TO HOLINESS (PETER'S CHARGE)

Biblical Focus: 1 Peter 1:13–17, 2:9–25

1. Preparation of the Mind

Witnessing begins internally. Peter charges Christians to "gird up the loins of their mind" (prepare their minds for action).

Self-Control: They must exercise self-control and set their hope fully on the grace to be revealed.

Non-Conformity: As obedient children, they must not return to the "former lusts" or ignorance they lived in before knowing Christ.

2. Conduct Among Non-Believers

Christians often work and live alongside critics. Peter advises a lifestyle that is "transparent, humble, and accountable".

The Strategy: Maintain good conduct among the Gentiles (non-Christians) so that, even if they speak against you as evildoers, they may see your good deeds and glorify God.

Honoring All: The command is four-fold: Honor all men, Love the brotherhood, Fear God, and Honor the King.

Submission: Christians should subject themselves to every human institution (constituted authority) for the Lord's sake.

III. PART 2: THE URGENCY OF THE TIMES (PAUL'S CHARGE)

Biblical Focus: Romans 13:11–14

1. The Wake-Up Call

Paul injects a sense of urgency. Good Christian living is important because "the time for reckoning is near".

- **Night vs. Day:** The "night" (era of sin) is far spent; the "day" (Christ's return) is at hand. Therefore, Christians must wake up from spiritual slumber.

2. The Armor of Light

Cast Off: We must remove the "works of darkness" (orgies, drunkenness, sexual immorality, debauchery, dissension, jealousy).

Put On: We must put on the "Lord Jesus Christ" like armor, making no provision for the flesh. The goal is to be a *replica* of Jesus Christ in society.

IV. PART 3: SOCIAL VICES VS. PEACEFUL COEXISTENCE

1. Understanding Social Vices

Definition: Social vices are negative tendencies and habits within a community that work against peace and progress .

Examples: Drug abuse, bribery, corruption, stealing, armed robbery, sexual promiscuity, tribalism, nepotism, and examination malpractice.

- **Impact on Witnessing:** These vices are "stumbling blocks." A Christian involved in exam malpractice or bribery destroys their testimony and cannot effectively witness for Christ.

2. Tolerance and Coexistence

Tolerance: The ability to be fair and understanding of people with different views, cultures, religions, or races.

Coexistence: Living together in the same space without discord or rancor.

Importance: It promotes nation-building, meaningful economic development, and harmony .

Note: Tolerance does not mean accepting sin; it means respecting the person while maintaining one's own faith.

V. PART 4: CIVIC RESPONSIBILITY AND CITIZENSHIP

Biblical Focus: Romans 13:1–7; 1 Peter 2:13–17

1. The Theology of Government

Students must understand *why* they obey the law.

Divine Origin: "There is no authority except from God, and those that exist have been instituted by God" .

Resistance: Therefore, to resist the government is to resist God Himself, which attracts judgment.

Purpose of Rulers: They are God's servants for your good—to punish bad conduct and reward good conduct.

2. Duties of a Good Citizen

A "Good Citizen" is one who is law-abiding and respects authority. Specific duties include:

Payment of Dues: Paying taxes, rates, levies, and electricity bills promptly.

Obedience: Obeying road signs, court injunctions, and laws .

Freedom: Using freedom as a servant of God, not as a cover-up for evil (pretext).

Avoidance of Crime: Staying away from anti-social behaviors like drug trafficking and cultism.

VI. SUMMARY: THE BALANCED LIFE

- **The Balance:** A Christian lives in two kingdoms: The Kingdom of God (Spiritual) and the State (Physical).
- **The Mandate:** We must be the best citizens of the State (paying taxes, obeying laws) to prove we are true citizens of Heaven.

VII. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions:

1. **Dilemma:** Paul says "submit to authorities" (Rom 13). What should a Christian do if the government commands them to do something clearly against God's law (like in Daniel 3)? Discuss the limits of submission.

Social Analysis: "Nepotism" (favoring relatives for jobs) is listed as a social vice. Why is this harmful to a nation's development, and how does it contradict the Christian value of fairness?

3. **Personal Application:** Identify one "Work of Darkness" (Rom 13:12) that is common among students (e.g., cheating, bullying) and explain how "putting on the Armor of Light" changes that behavior.

B. Objective Revision:

1. According to Romans 13, the night is far spent and the ____ is at hand. (*Answer: Day*)
2. Civic responsibilities are duties performed by citizens to ensure the ____ and ____ of their country. (*Answer: Peace and Progress*)
3. Peter advises Christians to honor the King and ____ the brotherhood. (*Answer: Love*)
4. List three social vices mentioned in the lesson. (*Answer: Drug abuse, bribery, corruption, stealing, etc.*)

C. Assignment:

- **Civic Project:** "The Model Citizen." Write a checklist of 5 things a Christian student should do *tomorrow* to show they are a good citizen of their school (e.g., obey the prefects, pick up trash, don't cut corners).

VIII. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Contextual Note:** Explain that in the time of Peter and Paul, the "King" was the Roman Emperor (often a persecutor). If the Apostles told Christians to honor *Nero*, how much more should we respect our leaders today? This highlights the radical nature of submission.
- **Differentiation:** Distinguish between **Civic Rights** (what the government owes you) and **Civic Responsibilities** (what you owe the government). This lesson focuses on the latter.
- **Key Definition:** Ensure students understand "**Nepotism**" and "**Tribalism**" as specific enemies of Christian Witnessing in a diverse society.

WEEK 4: CHRISTIANS ATTITUDES TOWARDS PERSECUTION

Theme: Resilience Under Fire

Biblical Texts: 1 Peter 3:13–17, 1:6–9, 4:12–19; James 1:12–15.

Duration: 1 Week

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. **Define** "Persecution" and identify its various forms (physical, social, emotional).
 2. **Analyze** St. Peter's analogy of "fire" and "gold" to explain the purpose of suffering.
 3. **Contrast** the correct Christian response to persecution (rejoicing/endurance) with the incorrect response (compromise/fear).
 4. **Evaluate** James' teaching on the source of temptation versus the source of trials.
-

II. PART 1: UNDERSTANDING PERSECUTION

Biblical Focus: General Introduction

1. Definition

What is it? Persecution is the act of mistreating, molesting, threatening, or killing someone specifically because of their religious beliefs or convictions.

Why does it happen? Christians are often hated or molested because they stand against societal evils like fraud, corruption, and cultism. Their righteousness exposes the darkness of others.

The Temptation: Because persecution involves pain, Christians are tempted to "condone evil" or compromise their standards to avoid trouble.

III. PART 2: PETER'S TEACHING (THE REFINING FIRE)

Biblical Focus: 1 Peter 1:6–9; 3:13–17; 4:12–19

St. Peter wrote to Christians who were facing intense hostility. His central message is that suffering is **necessary** and **purposeful**.

1. The Analogy of Gold

- **The Process:** Peter compares faith to gold. Gold is precious, but it is often mixed with impurities. To purify it, it must pass through fire.

The Purpose: Persecution is the "fire" that refines Christian faith. It burns away the "impurities" (hypocrisy, reliance on self) and leaves behind a pure, genuine faith that brings praise to Jesus Christ.

2. The Attitude: Rejoicing

- **Don't be Surprised:** Peter warns, "Do not be surprised at the fiery trial when it comes on you to test you, as though something strange were happening to you" (1 Peter 4:12). Suffering is normal for a believer.

Rejoice: Instead of complaining, Christians should maintain a positive attitude by rejoicing. Why? Because they are sharing in Christ's sufferings, so they will also share in His glory.

- **No Shame:** If you suffer as a murderer or thief, you should be ashamed. But if you suffer as a "Christian," do not be ashamed, but glorify God in that name (1 Peter 4:15-16).

3. The Hope

The Prophets: Peter reminds them that the prophets of old predicted both the suffering of the Messiah and the glory that would follow.

The Grace: Christians should comfort themselves by setting their hope on the grace that will be revealed at the second coming of Jesus.

IV. PART 3: JAMES' TEACHING (THE CROWN OF LIFE)

Biblical Focus: James 1:12–15

James focuses on the **reward** of endurance and clarifies the **source** of sin.

1. The Reward: The Crown of Life

- **Blessedness:** "Blessed is the man who remains steadfast under trial" (James 1:12).
- **The Outcome:** The suffering has an expiration date. Once the believer has stood the test, they will receive the "crown of life" which God has promised to those who love Him.

2. The Distinction: Trial vs. Temptation

James corrects a dangerous misconception:

God Does Not Tempt: "Let no one say when he is tempted, 'I am being tempted by God'". God tests faith to strengthen it, but He never tempts anyone to do evil.

- **The Source of Sin:** Temptation comes from **within**. A person is tempted when they are lured and enticed by their *own* desire (lust).
- **The Chain Reaction:** Desire (conceived) → Sin (born) → Death (fully grown).

V. SUMMARY: THE VICTORIOUS ATTITUDE

Resilience: It is not easy to live an exemplary life among peers who do evil, but prayer provides the grace to stand.

Perspective: Persecution is not a sign of God's absence; it is a "trial of faith". The Christian attitude must be one of **joy**, **endurance**, and **hope**.

VI. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions:

1. **Analogy Analysis:** Explain the "Gold and Fire" analogy. If a student is mocked for refusing to cheat on an exam, who is the "Gold," what is the "Fire," and what is the "Result"?
2. **Theological Distinction:** According to James, what is the difference between a "Trial" (from God) and a "Temptation" (from Self)?
3. **Modern Application:** Identify three forms of "persecution" a student might face in school today (e.g., exclusion from a group, cyberbullying for beliefs). How does Peter's advice to "rejoice" apply to these situations?

B. Objective Revision:

1. According to Peter, the trial of your faith is more precious than _____ which perishes. (*Answer: Gold*)
2. Who taught that "God tempts no one"? (*Answer: James*)
3. James promises that those who endure trial will receive the _____ of life. (*Answer: Crown*)
4. Persecution is defined as mistreatment specifically for the sake of religious _____. (*Answer: Beliefs/Interests*)

C. Assignment:

- **Reflective Journal:** Read 1 Peter 4:12-16. Write a paragraph encouraging a friend who is being bullied for being a "church boy" or "church girl." Use Peter's arguments to tell them why they should not be ashamed.

VII. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Visual Aid:** Bring a picture of a "Refiner's Fire" or a goldsmith working. Explain that the goldsmith keeps the gold in the fire *only* until he can see his reflection in it. Similarly, God keeps us in trials until He sees the image of Christ in us.
- **Key Distinction:** Ensure students understand that suffering for *doing wrong* (e.g., getting punished for stealing) is NOT persecution. Peter clearly says, "let none of you suffer as a murderer or a thief" (1 Peter 4:15). Persecution is suffering for *doing right*.

- **Vocabulary:** "Martyrdom" (dying for faith) is the ultimate form of persecution, but "Social Ostracism" (being ignored/hated) is more common for students.



WEEK 6: IMPARTIALITY

Theme: Divine Justice and Human Equality

Biblical Texts: James 2:1–13; Matthew 7:12; Luke 6:31.

Duration: 1 Week

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. **Define** "Impartiality" and "Nepotism," distinguishing between fair judgment and biased sentiment.
 2. **Analyze** St. James' warning against discrimination using the "Rich Man vs. Poor Man" case study.
 3. **Explain** the theological reasons why favoritism is a sin (God's nature, the Royal Law).
 4. **Evaluate** the negative impact of tribalism and nepotism on national development and unity.
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II. PART 1: THE MEANING OF IMPARTIALITY

Biblical Focus: General Introduction

1. Definition

Impartiality: This implies acting without bias or prejudice. It is a virtue that recognizes the equality and brotherhood of all humanity, irrespective of race, social background, or influence.

The Concept: It entails giving the right judgment or opinion on a situation without fear or favor. It is the blindfold on "Lady Justice"—looking at the facts, not the faces.

2. The Theological Foundation

- **Creation:** God made all humans equal from creation; He created each person in His own image and likeness.

Divine Nature: God treats all men generously despite their nationality or color. Therefore, possessing economic or material advantages does not nullify the rights bestowed equally on all humanity by God.

III. PART 2: THE SIN OF PARTIALITY (ST. JAMES' WARNING)

Biblical Focus: James 2:1–13

St. James addresses a specific problem in the early church where wealthy members were treated better than poor ones.

1. The Case Study (*The Church Service*)

James paints a vivid picture:

- **Scenario:** Two men enter the assembly. One is wearing gold rings and fine clothing; the other is a poor man in shabby clothes.

The Discriminating Action: The ushers tell the rich man, "*Have a seat here, please*" (honor), but tell the poor man, "*Stand there*" or "*Sit at my feet*" (dishonor).

The Verdict: James asks, "*Have you not made distinctions among yourselves and become judges with evil thoughts?*". He labels this behavior as evil because it judges value based on appearance.

2. Four Reasons to Reject Partiality

James provides logical arguments against favoritism:

God's Choice: God has chosen the poor in this world to be rich in faith and heirs of the Kingdom. Ignoring them is ignoring God's heirs.

Logic of Oppression: James reminds them that it is the rich who often oppress them, drag them to court, and blaspheme the name of Christ. It is foolish to honor those who persecute the faith.

The Royal Law: Discrimination violates the "Royal Law" of scripture: *"You shall love your neighbor as yourself"*.

The Nature of God: God Himself is not partial.

IV. PART 3: THE GOLDEN RULE

Biblical Focus: Matthew 7:12; Luke 6:31

1. The Universal Standard

The Command: During the Sermon on the Mount, Jesus taught: *"So treat others the way you would like them to treat you; for this is the law and the prophets"*.

- **Application:** Before acting towards someone, a Christian must ask: *"If I were in their shoes, how would I want to be treated?"*

Public Good: Christians should be mindful of their actions, placing the public good first in whatever they do .

V. PART 4: SOCIAL VICES – NEPOTISM AND TRIBALISM

The lesson applies the biblical principle of impartiality to modern societal issues.

1. Definitions

Nepotism: The unfair practice by a powerful person of giving jobs and other favors to relatives.

Favoritism: The unfair practice of treating some people better than others based on sentiment.

Tribalism: Loyalty to a tribe or social group combined with strong negative feelings for people outside that group.

2. Negative Effects on Society

These vices cripple the development of a society in the following ways:

Inefficiency: National wealth and political power are not properly distributed, leading to uneven development.

Disunity: They introduce disunity, negative feelings, and distrust among different segments of society.

Civil Strife: They encourage sectional interests and an inordinate desire for domination.

Lack of Patriotism: They kill the spirit of nationalism; people become loyal to their "clan" rather than their country.

VI. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions:

1. **Scenario Analysis:** A school prefect punishes a junior student for making noise but ignores his own friend who is doing the same thing. Which biblical principle is he violating, and what are the likely consequences for the class atmosphere?
2. **Theological Reflection:** James 2:5 says God chose the poor to be "rich in faith." Does this mean God prefers the poor over the rich? Explain the balance between "God is impartial" and "God chooses the poor."
3. **Societal Application:** Discuss how **Meritocracy** (rewarding ability) is the opposite of **Nepotism**. Why is Meritocracy more biblical according to the concept of Impartiality?

B. Objective Revision:

1. According to James, showing favoritism is a sin and a transgression of the _____. (*Answer: Law*)
2. The practice of giving jobs and favors to relatives is known as _____. (*Answer: Nepotism*)
3. "Treat others the way you would like them to treat you" is known as the _____ Rule. (*Answer: Golden*)

4. According to James, the "Royal Law" is to love your _____ as yourself. (*Answer: Neighbor*)

C. Assignment:

- **Essay (150 Words):** "The Danger of Tribalism in My School." Write about how tribalism or cliques affects school unity and propose one way students can fight it.
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VII. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Visual Aid:** Use a weighing scale (balance). Show that "Justice" requires the scale to be balanced. Then add a "weight" to one side labeled "My Brother" or "My Tribe." Show how the scale tips and justice is lost.
- **Key Distinction:** Clarify that loving your family (Natural Affection) is good, but letting that love pervert justice (Nepotism) is sin.
- **Class Activity:** Role-play the James 2 scenario. Have a student dress "rich" and another "poor." See how the class reacts to them entering the room before teaching the lesson.

WEEK 8 & 9: RESURRECTION AND THE SECOND COMING OF JESUS CHRIST

Theme: The Victory and The Hope

Biblical Texts: Matthew 28:1–8; Mark 16:1–8; 1 Thessalonians 4:13–18; 2 Thessalonians 2:1–12.

Duration: 2 Weeks

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this unit, students should be able to:

1. **Define** "Resurrection" and explain why it is the "hub" of the Christian faith.
 2. **Compare** the synoptic accounts of the Resurrection, focusing on the prominent role of women.
 3. **Analyze** the "Second Coming" (Parousia) and the concept of the Rapture.
 4. **Identify** the signs of the End Times, including the rise of the "Man of Lawlessness" (Antichrist), and discuss how believers should prepare.
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II. PART 1: THE RESURRECTION OF JESUS CHRIST

Biblical Focus: Matthew 28:1–8; Mark 16:1–8

1. Meaning and Significance

- **Definition:** Resurrection means rising from the dead. Specifically, it refers to Jesus Christ coming back to life on the third day after His crucifixion.
- **The Hub of Faith:** The resurrection is the central pillar of Christianity. Without it, the faith is dead. It proves that life does not end on earth but continues in the spiritual world.

The Proof: It confirmed that Jesus was who He claimed to be (the Son of God) and that He had power over sin and death. It also fulfilled the prophecy that God's "Holy One would not see corruption" (Psalm 16:10).

2. The Matthew Account (The Event)

The Visitors: On the first day of the week (Sunday), Mary Magdalene and "the other Mary" went to the tomb.

The Phenomenon: There was a violent earthquake because an angel descended, rolled away the stone, and sat on it.

The Reaction: The Roman guards were so frightened by the angel's dazzling appearance that they shook and "became like dead men".

- **The Message:** The angel told the women, *"Do not be afraid... He is not here, for He has risen"*. They were instructed to go to Galilee to meet Him .

3. The Role of Women

In a culture where women's testimony was often undervalued, the Bible highlights their crucial role:

Faithfulness: During Jesus' passion, when most male disciples fled, the women remained close .

Service in Death: They went to the tomb early to perform the burial custom of anointing the body, spending their own money on spices.

The Reward: Because of their love and courage, they were honored to be the **first witnesses** of the resurrection.

III. PART 2: THE SECOND COMING (PAROUSIA)

Biblical Focus: 1 Thessalonians 4:13–18; 2 Thessalonians 2:1–12

1. The Meaning of the Second Coming

- **The Rapture:** This refers to the return of Jesus Christ to take faithful Christians to heaven. It is the "blessed hope" of the believer .
- **The Timing:** Jesus taught that no one knows the day or hour; His coming will be sudden, like a "thief in the night".

2. Signs of the End (The Man of Lawlessness)

Paul warns the Thessalonians not to be easily deceived by false rumors that the day has already come. Certain things must happen first:

- **The Rebellion (Apostasy):** A great falling away from the faith.
- **The Antichrist:** The "Man of Lawlessness" will be revealed. He will exalt himself above God and perform fake miracles through satanic power.

The Delusion: God will send a "strong delusion" to those who refused to love the truth, causing them to believe the Antichrist's lies.

The Victory: Jesus will eventually destroy this Lawless One with the "breath of His mouth" and the brightness of His coming.

IV. PART 3: PREPARATION AND HOPE

1. How to Prepare

Since the timing is unknown, Christians must live in a state of readiness:

Holy Living: Living as "children of light," avoiding the works of darkness.

Hospitality & Love: Jesus taught that those who are not hospitable or loving will not inherit the kingdom (Matt 25).

Evangelism: Preaching the Second Coming to others to save them from the coming judgment.

2. Comfort for the Bereaved

Paul wrote about the Rapture specifically to comfort Christians who had lost loved ones.

- **Death is Sleep:** For the believer, death is merely a transition.

The Order of Resurrection: The "dead in Christ" will rise first, then those who are alive will be caught up together with them in the clouds.

The Conclusion: "Therefore comfort one another with these words".

V. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions:

1. **Historical Analysis:** Why is it significant that women were the first witnesses to the resurrection? How does this add credibility to the Gospel accounts? (Hint: If the disciples were inventing a story in the 1st Century, they would likely have used men as witnesses).
2. **Theological Reflection:** Explain the difference between "Resurrection" (Jesus/Believers) and "Resuscitation" (Lazarus). (Note: Lazarus died again; Jesus rose to eternal life).
3. **Modern Application:** How should the belief that "Jesus is coming like a thief" affect a student's attitude toward secret sins?

B. Objective Revision:

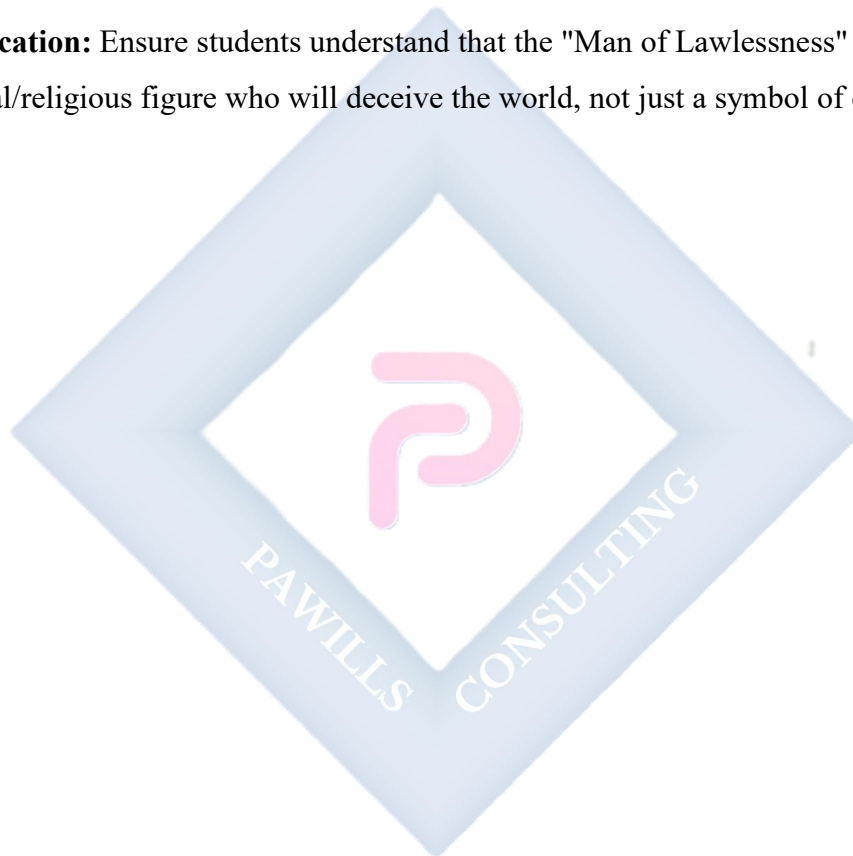
1. The resurrection is described as the _____ of the Christian faith. (*Answer: Hub*)
2. In the Matthew account, who rolled away the stone from the tomb? (*Answer: An angel*)
3. The "Man of Lawlessness" will be destroyed by the _____ of Jesus' mouth. (*Answer: Breath*)
4. Jesus likened the suddenness of His return to a _____ in the night. (*Answer: Thief*)

C. Assignment:

- **Comparison Chart:** Create a table comparing the **First Coming** of Jesus (Humility, Lamb, to Save) with the **Second Coming** (Glory, Lion/Judge, to Reign).

VI. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Visual Aid:** Draw a timeline. Point A: Cross/Resurrection. Point B: Church Age (Now). Point C: Rapture/Second Coming. Use this to explain the "Already but Not Yet" tension of the Kingdom.
- **Key Insight:** Emphasize that the purpose of teaching prophecy (Eschatology) is not to scare students but to urge them toward **holiness** and **evangelism**.
- **Clarification:** Ensure students understand that the "Man of Lawlessness" is a future political/religious figure who will deceive the world, not just a symbol of evil.



WEEK 10: THE SOVEREIGNTY OF GOD

Theme: The Absolute Monarch of the Universe

Biblical Texts: Genesis 1:1–31, 2:1–25.

Duration: 1 Week

I. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. **Define** "Sovereignty" regarding God's unlimited power and independence.
 2. **Compare** the First Account of Creation (Order/Cosmic) with the Second Account (Relational/Anthropocentric).
 3. **Analyze** the specific creative acts on each of the six days.
 4. **Discuss** how the creation of man (Imago Dei) demonstrates God's supreme authority.
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II. PART 1: THE CONCEPT OF SOVEREIGNTY

Biblical Focus: General Introduction

1. Definition

- **Secular Meaning:** "Sovereign" means "highest power" without limit. For humans, it implies total independence.
 - **Religious Meaning:** It refers to God's supremacy over the universe. He is the Supreme Commander and Controller. He created all things, and without Him, nothing exists.
 - **Dominion:** Although God gave man dominion over the earth (Gen 1:28), God's power supersedes man's power. Man is a steward; God is the Owner.
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III. PART 2: THE FIRST CREATION ACCOUNT (ORDER)

Biblical Focus: Genesis 1:1–31

This account highlights God's power to bring order out of chaos ("without form and void").

- **Day 1:** Creation of **Light**. Separation of Day and Night.
- **Day 2:** Creation of the **Firmament** (Sky/Heaven). Separation of waters above and below .
- **Day 3:** Separation of **Land and Sea**. Creation of **Vegetation** (Trees, plants) .
- **Day 4:** Creation of Celestial Bodies (**Sun, Moon, Stars**).
- **Day 5:** Creation of **Sea Creatures** and **Birds**.
- **Day 6:** Creation of **Land Animals** and **Man** (in God's image).
- **Day 7:** God **Rested**. He blessed the day and made it holy (Sabbath).

IV. PART 3: THE SECOND CREATION ACCOUNT (RELATIONSHIP)

Biblical Focus: Genesis 2:7–25

This account zooms in on the creation of humanity and their environment.

1. The Setting

- **Pre-Condition:** There was no rain yet, and no man to till the soil. A mist went up to water the earth .

2. The Creation of Man (Adam)

- **The Method:** God formed man from the **dust** of the ground.

The Spark: He breathed into his nostrils the **breath of life**, and man became a living soul. *Note: This shows a hands-on, intimate Creator.*

3. The Garden of Eden

Provision: God planted a garden for man's dwelling, filled with beautiful trees and food.

The Rivers: Four rivers flowed from Eden: **Pishon, Gihon, Tigris, and Euphrates.**

4. The Creation of Woman (Eve)

- **The Surgery:** God caused a deep sleep to fall on Adam, took one of his **ribs**, and closed up the flesh.

The Result: From the rib, He made a woman to be a helper suitable for him.

V. EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT

A. Critical Thinking Questions:

1. **Comparative Analysis:** The First Account (Gen 1) uses the name "Elohim" (God of Power), while the Second Account (Gen 2) uses "Yahweh" (God of Relationship). How do these two accounts give us a complete picture of God?
2. **Theological Reflection:** If God "rested" on the seventh day, does it mean He was tired? (Discuss "Rest" as completion/satisfaction, not exhaustion).
3. **Scientific Connection:** How does the order of creation (Plants → Animals → Man) reflect a logical progression of life support systems?

B. Objective Revision:

1. On which day did God create the Sun, Moon, and Stars? (*Answer: Day 4*)
2. In the second account of creation, man was formed from the _____ of the ground. (*Answer: Dust*)
3. The river _____ is one of the four rivers mentioned in Eden. (*Answer: Pishon/Gihon/Tigris/Euphrates*)
4. Sovereignty refers to God's _____ over the universe. (*Answer: Supremacy/Highest Power*)

C. Assignment:

- **Creative Writing:** Imagine you are Adam waking up for the first time. Write a descriptive paragraph of what you see in the Garden of Eden based on Genesis 2.
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VI. TEACHER'S GUIDE

- **Key Distinction:** Help students understand that Genesis 1 and 2 are not contradictory stories but complementary perspectives (Macro vs. Micro).
- **Visual Aid:** Bring some clay/dust to class. Ask a student to "make it alive." Use this to demonstrate the uniqueness of God's sovereign power to give life (Breath of God).
- **Sovereignty Application:** Conclude by explaining that because God is Sovereign, we are accountable to Him. He is the Owner; we are the tenants.

